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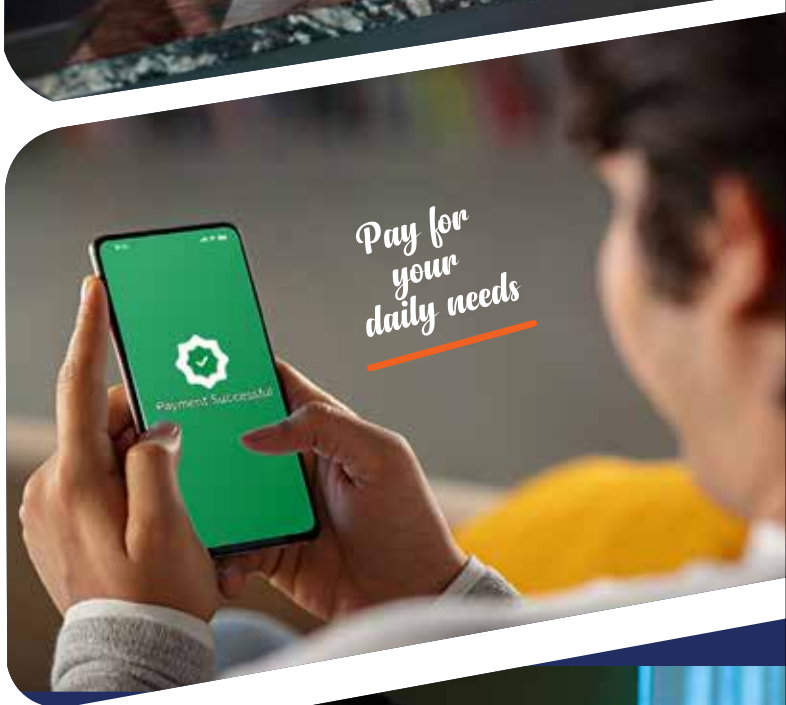
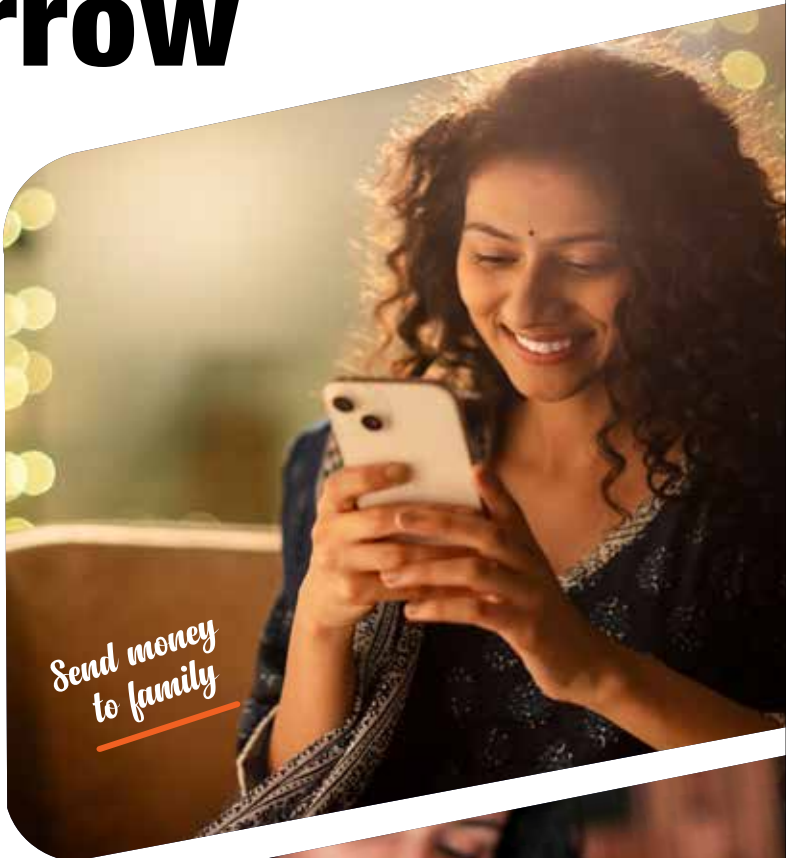
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News at a glance

Russia protests with Japan over US Typhoon missile

MOSCOW: Russia's Foreign Ministry said on Friday that it has made a formal protest to Japan over its decision to host US-made medium-range missile systems that Moscow sees as a threat.

The Foreign Ministry said its note of protest warned Tokyo that the deployment of the US Typhon missile systems on the island of Kyushu threatens Russia's security, regional peace, and stability and urged their removal. Earlier this week, Russia's Deputy Foreign Minister Andrei Rudenko met with Akira Muto, the Japanese ambassador.

Zelenskyy welcomes leaders from 7 nations for summit

KYIV: Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy welcomed leaders and representatives from seven regional countries for talks on deepening cooperation on Friday, as overnight Russian strikes in multiple regions sparked fires and caused several deaths and injuries.

The inaugural summit of the so-called "Carpathian Eight" brings together Ukraine, Romania, Serbia, Poland, Slovakia, the Czech Republic, Austria and Hungary, with the European Union also involved.



Shiite clerics carrying rifles march during a military-style parade at Revolution Square in Tehran on Friday

Pak will go to 'any extent' to defend Saudi Arabia: Army

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan will go to "any extent" to defend Saudi Arabia, a top army general has said, asserting that Islamabad's commitment to the Gulf Kingdom's security is "unconditional".

"Pakistan fully stands with the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia, both diplomatically and physically. And I would like to underscore here the word physically," Pakistan Army spokesman Lt Gen Ahmed Sharif Chaudhry told Arab News in an interview on Thursday. The drone was destroyed before it entered Mecca's prohibited airspace.

15 POLICEMEN AMONG DECEASED

Blast kills 21 near police facility in Pak during Friday prayers

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Peshawar, September 18

Militants detonated an explosives-laden vehicle at a mosque during Friday prayers and stormed nearby police facilities in Kohat district of northwest Pakistan, killing at least 21 people, mostly policemen, and wounding over 100 others, officials said.

The blast occurred at the mosque located near the old Police Lines in Kohat, around 60 kilometres southwest of Peshawar, in northwestern Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province.

Kohat Hospital Medical Superintendent Dr Tahir Shah said at least 21 people, including 15 policemen, were killed and 103 others injured in the explosions. Of the injured, 73 are policemen and 30 civilians, he added.

Among those killed was Dr Israel Khan Orakzai, Chief District Specialist at Liaquat Memorial Hospital, he was quoted as saying by Geo News.

A little-known militant group, Ittehad-ul-Mujahideen Pakistan, claimed responsibility for the attack. The group, an alliance comprising the Hafiz Gul Bahadur Group, Harakat Inqilab-e-Islami Pakistan and Lashkar-e-Islam, was formed in April 2025. Most of those killed and injured were police



Representational Image

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The blast occurred at the mosque located near the old Police Lines in Kohat
- » Video footage from the site showed the bodies of worshippers lying inside the mosque
- » Most of those killed and injured were police personnel offering Friday prayers at the mosque, rescue officials said

personnel offering Friday prayers at the mosque, rescue officials said.

Video footage from the site showed the bodies of worshippers lying inside the mosque. Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Inspector General of Police Zulfiqar Hamid said an explosives-laden vehicle rammed into the gate of the old police lines, triggering an explosion, followed by an exchange of gunfire

with armed militants.

"The vehicle hit the gate and then exploded, and firing also took place," Hameed said, adding that another suicide blast occurred at the Special Branch building during the exchange of fire with terrorists.

The blast occurred during Friday prayers, leaving a crater outside the mosque and severely damaging its exterior, while a wall also

collapsed. According to the Central Police Office in Peshawar, seven armed militants entered the police lines, where police and the Counter-Terrorism Department engaged them in a gun battle.

Six militants have so far been killed, including suicide bombers and snipers, the official said.

Security officials said security forces and police had cordoned off the area.

Thirteen injured were admitted at the Liaquat Memorial Hospital while 90 others were rushed to the District Headquarters Hospital, where an emergency was declared, Shah said.

According to Rescue 1122 Khyber Pakhtunkhwa spokesperson Bilal Ahmad Faizi, rescue teams reached the site shortly after receiving the information and launched a rescue operation.

Police said the Kohat-Hangu Road had been closed to all traffic and additional police contingents had been deployed near the police lines.

Rescue officials said nearby buildings were also damaged in the blast.

Following the blast, provincial police chief Hameed sought a report from the district's regional police officer. He directed authorities to ensure timely and best possible medical treatment for the injured.

Nepal floods: 6 bodies recovered from Upper Trishuli-1 tunnel

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Kathmandu, September 18

Six bodies were recovered from a tunnel at a hydropower project in Nepal on Friday as search operations continued for people missing after devastating flash floods hit the Himalayan nation last month killing over 1,400 people and leaving more than 6,100 missing.

The bodies were recovered from the Audit-3 tunnel at the Upper Trishuli-1 project site in Nuwakot district by a joint team of security forces, the Nepal Army said.

The Bhotekoshi flash floods, triggered by an ice-rock avalanche near the Nepal-Tibet border on August 26, devastated towns and villages in northern and central Nepal, killing at least 1,410 people and leaving 6,145 missing as of Thursday.

The search and rescue teams have so far rescued more than 13,756 people from different affected areas.

Macron orders protections for infra

Amid what he described as an intensifying Russian hybrid threat

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Paris, September 18

French President Emmanuel Macron said Friday he had asked his government to prepare a plan to protect critical infrastructure, including sensitive defence industry sites, against drone attacks and cyberattacks amid what he described as an intensifying Russian hybrid threat.

"In recent weeks, the threat -- particularly the Russian hybrid threat -- facing Europeans and France has intensified,"



French President Emmanuel Macron

Macron told reporters at the Elysee Palace after meeting political party leaders. Macron specifically cited drone attacks and cyberattacks against critical infrastructure. The European Union describes

Voting begins in Russian parliamentary election

Putin seeks re-election for 1st time

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Moscow, September 18

Russians on Friday began three days of voting in the country's first wartime parliamentary election, which features virtually no opposition and is all but certain to secure the Kremlin's political dominance.

Authorities spread the election over the weekend in a bid to boost turnout among the 111 million eligible voters and even allowed electronic balloting. Polls opened Friday and will close Sunday.

The Kremlin wants the parliamentary elec-

tion -- the first since the start of the full-scale invasion of Ukraine in 2022 -- to underline public support for the war and give a veneer of legitimacy to its action. It has sought to avoid any political risks by stamping out even the slightest sign of dissent.

"Your choice and resolve will once again demonstrate that millions of people stand behind our fighters, that we are a united people, bound by shared values, historical memory, and love for the Motherland," President Vladimir Putin told the nation before the vote.

IN RECENT WEEKS, THE THREAT FACING EUROPEANS AND FRANCE HAS INTENSIFIED

Russian hybrid activities as including sabotage, cyberattacks, disinformation and interference in democratic processes. Macron warned that the attacks would not go unanswered and accused Moscow of trying

ing to intimidate Europeans into weakening their support for Ukraine.

"We are not intimidated," he said, arguing that Europe's present and future security was at stake in Ukraine.

Macron also said he would convene a Group of Seven meeting in the coming weeks to coordinate the response to the energy crisis. He linked surging energy prices to the conflicts in the Middle East and Ukraine and disruption to shipping through the Strait of Hormuz.



BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION, MADHYA PRADESH

SHIVAJI NAGAR, BHOPAL-462011

No./998/DATA/2026

Bhopal, Dated : 18.09.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Online tenders are invited for "Data Processing and Result Processing" of TET Exam December 2026 and NMMSS examinations to be conducted by the BSE for the **academic year 2027-28 & 2028-29**. Only Computer Firms located outside the State of Madhya Pradesh may participate in the tender process. The Tender document is available on <https://mptenders.gov.in> detailed terms and conditions are mentioned in the tender document.

KEY DATES AND TIME

To submit online tenders logon to <https://mptenders.gov.in> Important dates for Online submission are:-

(1) Tender Document available on Portal :	19.09.2026	at	5 : 00 P.M.
(2) Downloading Tender document :	20.09.2026	from	5 : 00 P.M.
(3) Last Date for submission of Online Bid :	12.10.2026	up to	2 : 00 P.M.
(4) Technical Bid Opening :	13.10.2026	at	3 : 00 P.M.
(5) Commercial Bid Opening :	15.10.2026	at	3 : 00 P.M.

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The Executive Engineer Dehra Division HPPWD Dehra H.P. on behalf of Governor of H.P. invites the percentage rate bids, in the electronic tendering system from the eligible class of contractors registered with HPPWD for the works as detailed in the table.

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	Starting date for down-loading Bid.	Earnest Money	Deadline for submission of Bid.	Time Limit
1	Restoration of rain damages on various roads under HPPWD Sub Division Dehra and Haripur (SH- Repair to Pot Holes on (i) Dehrian to Patsia via Salehar in Km 2/300 to 5/800 (ii) Khabli to Meyoli road in Km 0/0 to 3/500, (iii) MandeliNarwari road in Km 0/0 to 1/800 (iv) Naker Bridge to MuhaliMandeli road in Km 0/0 to 1/035) (v) Muhali to HarNeighor in Km 0/0 to 4/800 (vi) Muhali to Dehrian road in Km 0/0 to 4/450, (v) Kundlihar to GHS Muhali in Km 0/0 to 2/00, (vi) Patsia Bhattha road in Km 0/0 to 2/500 (vii) Tattan Da Behra to Ghatli Da Ghatir at Patsia),(viii) KalahaPragpurDhalara Dada SibaSanarpur Terrace road in Km 9/0 to 22/200 at RD 18/200 to 19/00 & 19/300 to 20/000 (vii) NelanPukharSaout road in Km 0/00 to 0/500 & 0750 to 1/00 (ix) Dehra to Kuru Road in Km 0/220 to 2/825 (x) Taitai to Kuru Road in Km 0/0 to 0/950 & (xi) Kundlihar to Karlyara Road in Km 0/0 to 1/800 (xii) BangaliKatalab to BhatoliPhokorian via Rour Dibber road in Km 0/0 to 3/000 (xiii) Haripur to Rani KaMahol in Km 0/0 to 1/000 (xiv) Guler to Gathatar road in Km 0/0 to 3/000 (xv) Ranital to Lursu via Kuthar road in Km 0/0 to 6/000 (xvi) Guler to DhangerKhas road in Km 0/0 to 5/360 (xvii) Peer Bindli to Masoor Temple road in Km 0/0 to 2/800, (xviii) Bankhandi to Haripur road in Km 0/0 to 8/000 (xix) Ranital to Lursu via Kuthar road in Km 0/0 to 4/000 (xx) Dorkata to Banne Di Hatti road in Km 0/0 to 3/800 (xxi) Thathar to TripalKhas road in Km 0/0 to 3/000).	Rs.1,18,02,378/-	23.09.2026	Rs.2,36,000/-	28.09.2026	Three Months

The bidders are advised to note other details of tender from the department website www.hptenders.gov.in .
Tender:28.09.2026 .

No. 3477 /2026-2027

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Executive Engineer,
Dehra Division H.P.W.D., Dehra Pin No. 177101.
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on behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh

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Notice Inviting Tender

Tender is invited for Construction & Commissioning of 02 Nos. of new 33 KV line under Electric Supply Circle, Hazaribagh, Jharkhand on Turnkey basis.

NIT No.	Description	Estimate d value incl. GST (In Crs.)	EMD value incl. GST (In lacs).	Tender Cost incl. GST (In Rs.)	Download ing/ Sale of Tender Document	Pre-Bid Meeting	Last date of sale of Tender Document	Last Date of submission of Tender Document	Date of Opening of Tender
255/PR/ JBVNL/ 2026-27	Construction & Commissioning of two (02) Nos. of new 33 KV feeders originated from Chorkari Grid Sub Station (GSS) to Pachimo Village Tapping point for connecting 33 KV Padma-Ikthori feeder with Chorkari Grid under Section Ikthori ESSD- Chatra(N) for improving power to 33/11 Kv Ikthori PSS (from Bay-1) & 33/11 Kv Padma PSS (from Bay-2) on Turnkey Basis under ADP Head.	6.42	12.84	11,800	23.09.26	01.10.26 at 4.00 PM	13.10.26 up to 06:00 PM	13.10.26 at 06:00 PM	15.10.26 at 12:00 PM

Details against the above Tender can be obtained from website <https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> and may be contacted on Mobile No. 7004815844 & NIC helpline No. 0651-2400178. Submission of bid document fee and EMD will be accepted through online mode only and receipt of the same should be submitted to the office of undersigned on or before 14.10.2026.

PR 389964 (Jharkhand Bijlee Vitran Nigam Ltd) 26-27 (D)

Trump pushes his \$5,000 'dividend' pledge if GOP wins

US President Donald Trump

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Washington, September 18

US President Donald Trump came to battle-ground North Carolina doubling down on a tantalising and implausible midterm promise. "If we win," he said, "we're going to get you \$5,000. So that's it. Very simple."

The Republican candidates who spoke at the rally had nothing to say about it. Their silence reflects a broader pattern. About a week after the president unveiled his "Trump dividend" pledge at the party's unusual midterm convention in

Dallas, there is little evidence that Republicans in competitive races have incorporated it into their campaigns.The pledge hasn't been a staple of television advertising, whether from Trump's own political operation or his party's candidates. It usually only comes up when reporters ask about it, prompting most Republicans to sidestep the idea.

The Republican National Committee considers the proposed payments part of Trump's broader economic vision and says candidates should get behind it.

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No Half Truths

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VOL.21, ISSUE 260

DUSU POLLS SEE 40.46% TURNOUT
AS ABVP, NSUI VIE FOR TOP POST **P4**



PM TO DISTRIBUTE OVER 51K APPOINTMENT
LETTERS AT ROZGAR MELA TODAY **P8**

'NO IS NEVER
TAKEN AS NO' **P14**



NANDIGRAM BYPOLL

Mamata backs Cong, candidate arrested; symbol war to move to SC

AGNIHOTRI GUPTA

Kolkata, September 18

In the ongoing political saga ahead of the West Bengal bypolls, the Nandigram contest was thrown into fresh turmoil on Friday as Congress candidate Milan Pradhan was arrested by the state police, just minutes after former chief minister Mamata Banerjee announced that her faction would support him in the October 6 Assembly bypoll.

The dramatic turn of events came on a day of rapid-fire developments that had already reshaped the Nandigram contest and Bengal's political landscape, with Banerjee's candidate withdrawing from the race and the Election Commission of India (ECI) allotting new names and symbols to the rival TMC factions.



Former West Bengal CM Mamata Banerjee addresses a press conference, in Kolkata, on Friday **P11**

Party leader Kalyan Banerjee said that the party is likely to move the Supreme Court, challenging the ECI's decision to bar Mamata's faction from using the original "All India Trinamool Congress" name and its tra-

ditional "twin flowers & grass" symbol.

The legal challenge, if made, will add another front to the escalating battle over the identity and control of the TMC, with the poll panel having frozen the party's original

THE DRAMA

» Nandigram plunged into fresh turmoil as Congress candidate Milan Pradhan was arrested minutes after Mamata Banerjee announced her faction's support for him in the October 6 bypoll

» The arrest came after Mamata's candidate Sanchita Pradhan De withdrew from the contest following a meeting with Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari

» Mamata subsequently backed Pradhan, calling Congress a "sister party" and saying the move was aimed at strengthening Opposition unity and the INDIA bloc

» Mamata moved the Supreme Court against the ECI's decision to freeze her faction's use of the original TMC name and the traditional "twin flowers & grass" symbol.

» Mamata questioned the timing of Pradhan's arrest, alleging a BJP "usual formula" of digging up an old case to target the Opposition; Congress also alleged political motivation, while police linked the arrest to a 2007 Nandigram anti-land acquisition case

» Congress has announced protests outside police stations across Bengal on Saturday

name and symbol pending adjudication of the rival claims.

Earlier in the day, the Mamata-led TMC faction's Nandigram candidate, Sanchita Pradhan De, withdrew from the contest after meeting Chief Min-

ister Suwendu Adhikari, leaving the faction without a candidate in the seat. Banerjee subsequently announced her decision to back Congress nominee Pradhan, describing the move as being in the

CONTINUED ON P6

Twin TMC camps get new names, symbols for bypolls

DEBASHIS KONAR

Kolkata, September 18

TMC's twin camps will hit the bypoll campaign trail under new identities from Friday, after the Election Commission of India (ECI) stripped both factions of the party's name and iconic twin-flowers-and-grass symbol and allotted fresh names and symbols for the October 6 bypolls.

Mamata Banerjee's faction will contest as the "Mamata All India Trinamool Congress" (MAITMC) with the "Football Player" symbol, while the rival Arup Roy-led camp has been named "Democratic Trinamool Congress" and allotted the "Envelope" symbol.

The interim arrangement follows the poll panel's decision to freeze the original TMC identity pending a final ruling on the rival claims over the party's organisational control.

The ECI stepped in to prevent a potentially unprecedented situation

NEW IDENTITY

- » Mamata Banerjee's faction will contest as Mamata All India Trinamool Congress (MAITMC) with the Football Player symbol
- » The Arup Roy-led faction has been allotted the name Democratic Trinamool Congress and the Envelope symbol
- » Both factions will be treated as recognised political parties in West Bengal, Meghalaya and Tripura
- » The arrangement affects the Rejinagar and Nandigram Assembly bypolls in Bengal and the Nagaon Lok Sabha bypoll in Assam

in the ensuing West Bengal bypolls on Oct 6. Thus, it allowed candidates backed by rival factions of the Trinamool Congress to remain in the contest despite the freezing of the party's name and election symbol on Thursday before a final decision was made.

The intervention came a day after the EC barred both factions from using the name "All India Trinamool Congress" and its reserved "Flowers & Grass" symbol pending adjudication.

The faction led by Mamata Banerjee was allotted the name "Mamata All India Trinamool Congress" and the "Football

Player" symbol.

EC allotted "Democratic Trinamool Congress" and the "Envelope" symbol to the faction led by Arup Roy.

Both were to be treated as recognised political parties in West Bengal, Meghalaya and Tripura, the ECI missive said.

The decision has direct consequences for the Rejinagar and Nandigram Assembly bypolls in Bengal and the Nagaon Lok Sabha bypoll in Assam. In both Bengal constituencies, two candidates had submitted nominations claiming to represent the TMC.

The ECI noted that without

CONTINUED ON P6

Briefs

HC: No victory procession after DUSU results

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court on Friday banned victory processions following the Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU) election results and sought replies from candidates and student organisations on why electoral damages should not be imposed for violating norms.

A bench of Chief Justice D K Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia acted after noting repeated violations of the Lyngdoh Committee recommendations. Voting was underway on Friday, with counting scheduled for Saturday.

The court directed Delhi Police to prevent processions on Delhi roads, campuses and hostels, warning that violations

Asiad: Bhaker, Toor India's flag-bearers

NAGOYA: Double Olympic medalist Manu Bhaker and defending shot put champion Tajinder Singh Toor will lead India as flag-bearers at Saturday's Asian Games opening ceremony. India's 158-member contingent will attend the ceremony, deputy chef de mission Anjali Bhagwat said. Bhaker became the first athlete from independent India to win two medals at a single Olympics in Paris in 2024. Toor has won gold at the last two Asian Games. At Hangzhou 2023, athletics won 29 medals and shooting 22, while India's overall tally was a record 107 medals, including 28 gold. **SEE P13**

Over 37 lakh SIR appeals pending before WB SIR tribunal, EC tells SC

SOUMYADIP MULLICK

Kolkata, September 18

More than 37 lakh appeals arising from West Bengal's Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls remain pending before appellate tribunals, highlighting the scale of the legal challenge faced after the exercise.

The Election Commission has informed the Supreme Court that 38,20,683 appeals have been lodged against orders passed in connection with the SIR. Of these, only 1,02,231 have so far been disposed of, leaving 37,18,452 matters pending.

The figures were placed before a bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant and comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana in response to a petition by West Bengal Congress SIR committee chairperson Prasennjit Bose. The petition sought Assembly constituency-wise details of claims and objections concerning electors affected by the revision.

SIR TRIBUNAL

» The Election Commission has informed the Supreme Court that 38,20,683 appeals have been lodged against orders passed in connection with the SIR

» Of these, only 1,02,231 have so far been disposed of, leaving 37,18,452 matters pending

» The EC's data also showed that 34.13 lakh Form 6 applications seeking inclusion in the electoral rolls were submitted between publication of the draft roll on December 17, 2025 and August 7, 2026

The EC's data also showed that 34.13 lakh Form 6 applications seeking inclusion in the electoral rolls were submitted between publication of the draft roll on December 17, 2025 and August 7, 2026. These included applications from both new voters and people whose names had been left out during the revision.

CONTINUED ON P6

India says 'dangerous' manoeuvres by Pak naval vessel caused incident

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 18

India on Friday rejected Pakistan's allegation that an Indian Navy warship caused a collision with a Pakistani naval vessel in the Arabian Sea, saying the incident resulted from a "dangerous" overtaking manoeuvre by PNS Hunain that violated a 1991 bilateral agreement and international maritime rules. The collision took place on September 15 in the North Arabian Sea, with India maintaining that it occurred in international waters, while Pakistan has claimed it happened inside its Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ) during its SEA-SPARK-26 naval exercise.

External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said INS Kolkata, a stealth guided missile destroyer, was on routine deployment in the western Arabian Sea when the Pakistani vessel approached it at high speed.

CONTINUED ON P6

PM Modi and UAE Prez discuss West Asia, strategic partnership

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

New Delhi, September 18

UAE President Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan on Friday called Prime Minister Narendra Modi and discussed the evolving situation in West Asia and measures to further deepen the India-UAE Comprehensive Strategic Partnership. The two leaders also reaffirmed their commitment to continued cooperation and coordination to promote peace, security and stability in the region, according to



the Prime Minister's Office.

The call also had a personal note, with Sheikh Mohamed conveying warm birthday wishes to Modi, who turned 76 on Thursday. Thanking the UAE president, Modi described him as his "brother" in a post on X.

During the conversation, the two leaders discussed new measures to expand bilateral cooperation in energy, defence, technology, investment and health. The discussions come as India and the UAE continue to broaden their partnership beyond traditional economic and trade ties.

The West Asia situation figured prominently in the talks, with both sides exchanging views on developments in the region and reiterating their commitment to

AMID NEET LEAK CONCERNS

SC may visit NTA office to assess reforms

'Nilekani-led panel on NEET reforms to submit first report by month-end'

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 18

The Supreme Court on Friday said institutionalising reforms in the National Testing Agency (NTA) was essential to prevent recurring NEET paper leaks and indicated that the judges

may visit the agency's upgraded Delhi facility to assess whether the new system is functioning effectively. A bench of Justices P S Narasimha and Alok Aradhe said the examination system needs a permanent structure, staff and dedicated verticals,

with minimal deputations. "Permanency of the entire system is key," the bench told Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, who said the NTA had overhauled its administrative and infrastructure arrangements, although its human

CONTINUED ON P6

Anti-drug warning now must in films

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 18

Films showing the consumption, use or trafficking of narcotic drugs or psychotropic substances will now have to carry a mandatory anti-drug warning under revised film certification guidelines notified by the Centre on September 16 under the Cinematograph Act. The warning will read: "Illicit Narcotics Destroy Health and Guarantees Imprisonment. Say No to Drugs." Earlier, the CBFC was required to ensure that drug addiction was not encouraged, justified or glorified, but no specific warning was prescribed. The same warning was made mandatory for OTT platforms last month and advised for private satellite television channels. The guidelines were last amended in May 2025. **SEE P14**

IN LAST 10 YEARS FCRA-registered NGOs down by half; foreign funding rises to Rs 22,974 crore

New Delhi, September 18

The number of active NGOs registered under the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA) has fallen by nearly half over the past decade, even as foreign contributions received by such organisations have increased by more than Rs 5,000 crore, according to data presented by the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) before a Joint Parliamentary Committee examining proposed amendments to the law.

MHA officials, led by Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan, told the 31-member JPC, headed by BJP MP Sanjay Jaiswal, that 14,466 FCRA-registered NGOs are currently active across 15 states.

KEY POINTS

- » Active NGOs fell from 29,022 in 2015 to 14,466
- » Foreign funding rose to Rs 22,974 crore in 2024-25
- » Funding stood at Rs 17,832 crore in 2015-16
- » Religious associations received Rs 5,150 crore in 2024-25

- » Christian associations received Rs 1,345 crore in 2024-25
- » Hindu NGOs received Rs 328 crore during 2024-25
- » US donors contributed Rs 12,113 crore during 2024-25
- » Rs 35,968 crore remained unutilised in foreign contributions
- » Rs 21,140 crore of unutilised

funds remained in fixed deposits

» Government cancelled FCRA registrations of 21,983 NGOs



The figure stood at 29,022 in 2015. Despite the decline in the number of active organisations, foreign contributions rose from Rs 17,832 crore in 2015-16 to Rs 22,974

crore in 2024-25. Tamil Nadu has the largest number of active FCRA associations at 2,102, followed by Maharashtra with 1,578, Karnataka with 1,355,

CONTINUED ON P6

Marathi film 'Gondhal' is India's pick for Oscars 2027

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Mumbai, September 18

Marathi film Gondhal, written and directed by Santosh Davakhkar, has been selected as India's official entry for the Best International Feature category at the 99th Academy Awards, the Film Federation of India (FFI) announced on Friday.

The film was chosen from 33 entries considered by the selection committee, chaired by filmmaker P Sheshadri. "This time the official entry is 'Gondhal'," Sheshadri said, adding that the committee watched all 33 films over 10 days. He

said Angh and Ikkis were among the other films in the final three.

Set in rural Maharashtra, Gondhal unfolds over a night during a traditional ritual centred on a newlywed couple. The story follows Suman, played by Ishita Deshmukh, who is caught in an oppressive marriage and plans a murder and escape with her lover.

Kishor Kadam, Yogesh Sohani, Nishad Bhoir, Anuj Prabhu and Dhru Thoke also feature in the film. Veteran composer Ilaiyaraaja has scored its music.

The film premiered at the 56th

CONTINUED ON P6

DUSU polls see 40.46% turnout as ABVP, NSUI vie for top posts

Students raise concerns over high rents, closed hostels and accessibility

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 18

A 40.46-per cent voter turnout was recorded in the Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU) polls on Friday, with the ABVP and the NSUI locked in a keen contest, months after a youth-centric protest at Jantar Mantar brought questions of accountability and student concerns into sharper focus.

Last year, the student elections across a majority of Delhi University (DU) colleges recorded a voter turnout of 39.45 per cent.

The counting of votes will begin at 8 am on Saturday, with the results of the prestigious DUSU polls set to offer an indication of which student group has best gauged the mood and concerns of the university's students.

The Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) won several college union polls across the DU on Friday, registering a clean sweep at the Shri Ram College of Commerce (SRCC), winning the president and secretary posts along with both councillor seats.

The Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh-affiliated organisation said it has put up a strong show in the college elections, recording clean sweeps in several colleges, and expressed confidence in securing a 4-0 victory in the DUSU polls despite the efforts of the



“THE POLLS SAW CAMPAIGN ACTIVITIES THAT APPEARED TO VIOLATE SEVERAL RULES GOVERNING STUDENT ELECTIONS, WITH PRINTED PAMPHLETS SCATTERED AROUND THE NORTH CAMPUS, VEHICLE RALLIES...

‘Confident of 4-0 sweep’

New Delhi, September 18

Pointing to its performance in Delhi University college union elections, the ABVP on Friday expressed confidence of winning all four posts in the DUSU polls.

The organisation said it secured clean sweeps in Aditi Mahavidyalaya, Sri Aurobindo College (Morning), Shivaji College, Bharati College, Dr Bhim Rao Ambedkar College and Shri Ram College of Commerce. It also claimed key posts at Keshav Mahavidyalaya and Shyama Prasad Mukherjee College. The ABVP said its DUSU candidates – Yash Dabas, Eshu Maurya, Riya Chhabri and Lakshyaraj Singh – had received strong support and expressed confidence of a “4-0” victory. MPOST

isations and candidates to explain why electoral damages should not be imposed on them for violation of norms.

A bench of Chief Justice D K Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia passed the directions after observing that there were frequent and blatant violations of the Lyngdoh Committee recommendations during the DUSU polls.

The polls saw campaign activities that appeared to violate several rules governing student elections, with printed pamphlets scattered around the North Campus, vehicle rallies and the distribution of campaign materials around the South Campus.

Around the North Campus, printed pamphlets bearing candidates' names were scattered on roads and footpaths. People travelling in vehicles threw pamphlets, particularly around Chhatra Marg and near colleges, such as Kirori Mal and Hansraj, while students on motorcycles distributed candidate cards as they moved between colleges.

DU students raised concerns over affordable accommodation, functioning hostels, food and transport, while the ABVP and NSUI traded allegations during polling. Over 2,000 police and paramilitary personnel were deployed across campuses.

Rohit Godara gang member held with Rs 12 cr Pak heroin

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 18

The Delhi Police Special Cell, in a joint operation with the Vadodara City Crime Branch, has arrested a 31-year-old alleged member of the Rohit Godara-Mahender Delana gang and seized two kg of heroin of Pakistani origin, valued at around Rs 12 crore, officials said on Friday.

The accused, Kuldeep Swami, was wanted in a Rs 10-crore extortion case registered by the Vadodara City Crime Branch, in which the first instalment of the extortion money was allegedly to be collected in Delhi, they said.

Acting on intelligence shared by the Gujarat Police, a joint team intercepted Swami in Kucha Ghasi Ram, Chandni Chowk, around 5.30 pm on September 12, police said. A currency note allegedly used as a hawala verification token and keys to a car were recovered from him.

During interrogation, Swami allegedly disclosed that a consignment of narcotics had been concealed in the vehicle parked in Jai Vihar, Phase-I, Najafgarh. The team searched the car and recovered four packets containing around two kg of heroin hidden in a specially fabricated cavity near the spare-tire area of the boot, officials said.

A case under Sections 21 and 25 of the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act was subsequently registered at the

A JOINT TEAM INTERCEPTED SWAMI IN KUCHA GHASI RAM, CHANDNI CHOWK, AROUND 5.30 PM ON SEPTEMBER 12...

Special Cell police station on September 13, they said.

According to the investigation, the gang allegedly operated a network that combined extortion-money collection and drug trafficking. Communication between operatives was carried out through social media platforms using pre-decided code words, live locations and photographs of currency notes to authenticate cash or drug handovers, police said.

Swami allegedly worked as a courier for the network and collected extortion amounts ranging from Rs 5 lakh to Rs 50 lakh per transaction across Delhi-NCR and Rajasthan. He was allegedly paid Rs 15,000 to Rs 20,000 for each assignment, officials said.

Police said Swami travelled to Amritsar on September 5 to collect heroin for Delana, concealing it in his car before returning to Delhi.

He allegedly joined the network after suffering losses of over Rs 50 lakh in commodity trading. Investigators are probing links with gangster Rohit Godara, hawala routes and other associates.

Police expands ‘Shishtachar’ squads to curb harassment

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

New Delhi, September 18

The Delhi Police will strengthen its district-wise ‘Shishtachar’ Anti-Eve Teasing Squads to prevent harassment and other crimes against women in public spaces, officials said on Friday.

A meeting to review the squads' functioning was chaired by the Special Commissioner of Police, SPU-WAC, with district DCPs at Police Headquarters.

Officials were directed to identify and regularly map hotspots and vulnerable points and ensure systematic deployment of squads during sensitive timings. The teams will conduct regular patrolling and preventive drives, with personnel rotated to ensure wider coverage. Plain-clothes female personnel may also be deployed as decoys to identify and deter offenders.

Special emphasis was placed on public transport, with squads asked to conduct surprise checks and interact with drivers, conductors and passengers to identify habitual offenders and encourage reporting.

Police will also involve RWAs, MWAs and local volunteers in community-based prevention efforts.

Personnel selected for the squads were directed to remain sensitive and empathetic, while ensuring victims are not subjected to unnecessary public scrutiny. District DCPs will monitor deployments, hotspot coverage and compliance with guidelines.

73-yr-old arrested after car hits biker

New Delhi, September 18

A 73-year-old man was arrested after his car allegedly hit a biker and dragged his motorcycle for around 100 metres on Africa Avenue Road in south Delhi's R K Puram area, police said on Friday.

Police said the blue sedan, allegedly driven by Venu Gopal, a Vasant Kunj resident, was travelling from Bhikaji Cama Place towards R K Puram Metro Station around 10 pm on Thursday when it hit 21-year-old Tanish Tokas, who was sitting

on his parked motorcycle by the roadside.

Tokas fell from the motorcycle due to the impact, while the bike got dragged by the car before the vehicle stopped. He underwent a medical examination and was found to have suffered no serious injuries. A video of the incident showed a crowd confronting the driver after the car stopped. Some people alleged he was drunk.

Police received information around 10.22 pm and rushed to the spot. MPOST

CCTV trail & peculiar tempo symbol help police crack teen girl’s gang rape-murder

New Delhi, September 18

A peculiar symbol on a tempo, spotted during analysis of around 50 CCTV cameras, helped Delhi Police trace four people allegedly involved in the gang rape and murder of a teenage girl, whose decomposed body was found in an open field here, officials said.

The girl, aged around 15-17, was allegedly raped, stabbed to death and dumped in an open field by four people, including three juveniles, after she went with them in the tempo. The

TEMPO WAS TRACED TO KHADDA COLONY IN SWAROOP NAGAR...

accused knew the girl and allegedly drank with her before the incident, police said.

Her body was found near Jaipal Rana's field on Kushak Road on September 13. It was highly decomposed, with stray dogs having eaten parts of it and one hand separated from the body. The gender could not initially be established. Police said

the family had not filed a missing complaint as the girl would often leave home and return after a few days. Her daily-wage labourer parents also lacked documents establishing her exact age. A doctor later estimated it at 15-17 years.

With no eyewitnesses, immediate clues or CCTV near the spot, investigators traced a tempo captured by a distant camera. Its registration number was obscured by darkness, but a distinctive round-ring symbol and an AC unit helped investiga-

tors track it through around 50 cameras.

The tempo was traced to Khadda Colony in Swaroop Nagar during a night-long operation on September 15-16. The driver, Shivam alias Sudama alias Chuchu, was identified and questioned, leading to the apprehension of three juveniles, aged 16 and 17.

Police recovered two knives, clothes allegedly worn by the accused and the tempo. Further investigation is underway. MPOST

A WEDDING IN SIGHT, THEN A DISAPPEARANCE

Family seeks answers after missing man’s body cremated days before identification

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 18

A wedding just weeks away, a newly finalised sherwani and a promise to return home after a meeting - that was the last known chapter in the life of 31-year-old Yuvraj Singh Manchanda, whose disappearance ended in an alleged murder and the discovery of his body in a Gurugram drain.

But for his family, the tragedy did not end with his death. Yuvraj's family allege that his body was recovered on September 10 by Gurugram Police, but they were not informed and that it was cremated four days later without their knowledge.

The family said they learnt about the recovery only during the investiga-



YUVRAJ'S DISAPPEARANCE WAS PARTICULARLY ALARMING FOR THE FAMILY BECAUSE OF HIS RESPONSIBILITIES AT HOME...

tion into his disappearance after approaching the Delhi Police.

Speaking to a reporter, Yuvraj's sister Karishma said the family had last spoken to him around 7.30 pm on September 6, when he told them that the woman he was going to meet would arrive in about 20 minutes and that he would call them after the meeting.

“He had gone to Lajpat

with us for wedding shopping. His wedding was to happen in a month. After finalising his sherwani, he left, saying he had a meeting with a former woman colleague. He had also informed his fiancée and his boss about the meeting,” she said.

He said he would call after the meeting. “After that, we only received messages,” Karishma said.

According to her, Yuvraj

initially messaged that he was fine, asked the family not to worry and said his phone might get switched off. Later, he said he would return on Saturday and subsequently changed the date to Thursday.

“Then my sister requested him to at least show his face. She asked why he was not calling or coming home. He never does this. We started getting panicked because he never does anything wrong,” she said.

Yuvraj's disappearance was particularly alarming for the family because of his responsibilities at home. His father suffers from partial paralysis, and his mother also frequently remains unwell, according to the family.

“Since he was young, he had taken responsibility

for his home,” his childhood friend Rajat Jain said.

Jain said Yuvraj was known to his family since childhood and had attended his younger brother's wedding recently. The family waited for Yuvraj to return before approaching the police on September 11, five days after he went missing.

The Delhi Police investigation subsequently focused on his former colleague Anya Vats, with whom he had his last known phone conversation, and her husband Sanyam Sachdeva.

Police said Vats and Sachdeva allegedly confessed to killing Yuvraj and dumping his body in a Gurugram drain. His family questioned the handling and cremation of the unidentified body.

320 Tirthali farmers get YEIDA residential plots

Allotment under 7% abadi-plot policy

DIPIKA KIROLA

Greater Noida, September 18

The Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority (YEIDA) on Thursday allotted seven per cent residential plots to 320 farmers of Tirthali village through a draw, advancing the settlement of land-related entitlements for farmers affected by development projects in the area.

The draw was held at the YEIDA office in the presence of eligible beneficiaries and was photographed and photographed as part of the process. Officials from the land records and planning departments supervised the proceedings.

The plots have been earmarked in Sector 29 for farmers whose land was purchased by the author-

ity. Officials said beneficiaries were selected after scrutiny of land records and eligibility documents.

The allotment was made under YEIDA's seven per cent abadi-plot policy, under which eligible landowners whose agricultural land is acquired for planned development

are entitled to residential plots equivalent to seven per cent of the acquired area, subject to applicable conditions.

Tirthali is among the villages where YEIDA has been processing claims under the scheme.

The authority has been issuing eligibility lists and conducting village-wise allotments after scrutiny and inviting objections and suggestions.

The latest draw is part of YEIDA's efforts to clear pending farmer-related allotments.

Just 12 days, 47.5 lakh names: Delhi SIR in race against time

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 18

With just 12 days left for the claims and objections window under Delhi's Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, the response to the draft roll remains a key focus, with 73,496 applications for inclusion received since August 31 against 47,56,722 electors whose enumeration forms were not received during the revision exercise.

According to the latest status report issued by the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO), Delhi, 99,787 appli-

cations across different categories were received between August 31 and September 17. These comprise 73,496 Form 6 applications, 1,035 Form 7 applications, 25,103 Form 8 applications and 153 Form 6A applications.

The numbers offer a measure of the response so far. The 73,496 Form 6 applications amount to around 1.55 per cent of the 47.56 lakh electors whose names were left out of the draft roll. Even if all categories of applications are taken together, the figure of 99,787 is around 2.1 per

cent of the excluded-elector figure.

However, the two figures represent different stages and categories of the SIR process and cannot be treated as a one-to-one comparison. Not every elector whose enumeration form was not received would necessarily have to file a fresh Form 6, while the claims period also covers corrections, objections and other categories of applications.

The district-wise figures show considerable variation in the number of Form 6 applications



received since August 31. West recorded the highest number at 9,245, followed by North West at 7,527, East

at 7,315, South East at 7,184 and North East at 6,594. At the other end, New Delhi recorded 1,369 applications, while Old Delhi recorded 3,106.

The Form 8 numbers also indicate that the claims window is being used substantially for changes to existing entries. A total of 25,103 Form 8 applications have been received, with North East recording the highest district-wise figure at 3,058, followed by East at 2,875 and West at 2,589.

Delhi had 1,45,10,299 electors before the SIR exercise. Enumeration

forms were received for 97,53,577 electors, resulting in the draft roll published on August 31, while 47,56,722 electors were left out of the draft.

However, the scale of the gap means that a significant increase in outreach could be required if a larger proportion of the excluded electorate is to return to the process. Even if 10 percent of the 47,56,722 electors left out of the draft were to seek inclusion, that would amount to around 4.76 lakh applications, requiring an average of nearly 39,600 Form 6 applications a day

during the remaining 12 days. With September 30 as the deadline, the CEO has scheduled special camps at all polling station locations on September 20 and 27. Electors whose names are missing can submit Form 6 with the prescribed declaration and supporting documents, while Form 8 can be used for shifting or modification of existing entries. Claims and objections received by September 30 will be disposed of by October 29, with the final electoral roll scheduled to be published on November 4.

MINISTER PARVESH INSPECTS AFRICA AVENUE WORK PAST MIDNIGHT
600 km roads, November 30 deadline

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 18

Public Works Department Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh inspected road resurfacing work at Africa Avenue past midnight on Thursday and set a November 30 deadline for improving 600 km of major roads across Delhi, while directing officials to maintain quality standards during the ongoing works.

During the surprise inspection, the minister reviewed the progress of resurfacing and directed officials to ensure that quality was not compromised. A third-party agency has also been deployed with specialised equipment to check the quality and thickness of road surfaces.

“Our target is clear, 600 km of Delhi's major roads will be improved by November 30. I have instructed



officials that there will be no compromise on quality. Every road being resurfaced must meet the required standards, and the work must be completed within the deadline,” Singh said.

The minister said contractors would be held accountable for the quality and long-term maintenance of the roads. Under the new conditions, agen-

cies executing the works will also be responsible for maintaining the roads for five years after completion.

Explaining delays in resurfacing, Singh said disruptions in bitumen supply and a substantial increase in prices amid the global situation had affected the pace of work. “There was a disruption in bitumen supply and prices had increased

substantially because of the global situation. This affected the pace of work. Fresh tenders have now been issued and work is being taken up again on a priority basis. We will make full use of the available working window before winter sets in,” he said.

The PWD currently manages around 1,400 km of roads in Delhi, which are

“OUR TARGET IS CLEAR, 600 KM OF DELHI'S MAJOR ROADS WILL BE IMPROVED BY NOVEMBER 30. I HAVE INSTRUCTED OFFICIALS THAT THERE WILL BE NO COMPROMISE ON QUALITY — MINISTER

being taken up for improvement in phases. The department has directed officials to accelerate road works before severe winter conditions affect road-laying operations.

According to PWD orders issued in August, micro-surfacing of 28.155 km of roads in the South Zone has been sanctioned at a cost of Rs 12.33 crore.

In the North Zone, Rs 48.04 crore has been sanctioned for micro-surfacing 152.409 km, while the East Zone has received approval of Rs 32.81 crore for 59.27 km.

Together, the three orders cover 239.834 km at a sanctioned cost of around Rs 93.18 crore.

The North Zone sanction order also lays down a specific condition for roads still under the Defect Liability Period. Before taking up micro-surfacing on such stretches, field divisions have been directed to examine the relevant contract and certify that the work is not meant to rectify defects attributable to defective workmanship or materials of the contractor. As per the order they must also ensure that any expenditure contractually recoverable from the contractor is not borne by the government.

Delhi begins Budget exercise for 2027-28
Depts to submit estimates by Oct 12

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 18

The Delhi government has begun preparations for the 2027-28 Budget while undertaking a review of spending projections for the ongoing financial year, with all departments directed to submit their estimates to the Finance Department by October 12.

The Finance Department has issued guidelines for preparing Revised Estimates (RE) for 2026-27 and Budget Estimates (BE) for 2027-28. The proposals are to be prepared in the prescribed formats and in accordance with the General Financial Rules, 2017.

Along with the estimates, departments can submit proposals related to schemes, programmes and projects to the Director (Planning). The Finance Department has scheduled pre-Budget and RE meetings from the last week of October, with individual dates and timings to be communicated separately.

The government has emphasised that departments should base their projections on a realistic assessment of the funds they are likely to require and spend during the financial year. The directive comes against the backdrop of instances where departments sought additional funds despite spending less than their original allocations. The Finance Department, citing audit observations, also flagged

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The govt has emphasised that departments should base their projections on a realistic assessment of the funds they are likely to require and spend during the financial year
- » The directive comes against the backdrop of instances where departments sought additional funds despite spending less than their original allocations

cases of supplementary demands and re-appropriation of funds being made without adequate assessment of actual requirements. The circular noted that there had also been instances where departments sought re-appropriation despite having the capacity to utilise their original budget allocations. In other cases, expenditure at the end of the financial year was either higher or lower than the amount originally provided in the Budget.

The departments have consequently been asked to ensure that the amounts projected in both the revised and upcoming budget estimates are realistic and capable of being utilised within the respective financial year. Before forwarding their proposals, departments will also have to get them scrutinised by their respective Integrated Financial Advisers (IFAs).

Briefs

Mata Gujri Hospital gets new NICU

NEW DELHI: Delhi Mayor Pravesh Wahi on Friday inaugurated a 13-bed neonatal intensive care unit (NICU) and several new medical facilities at Mata Gujri Hospital in Tilak Nagar, west Delhi. The hospital has a dedicated ward for beneficiaries of the Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (PMJAY) and MCD employees, along with new equipment for ophthalmology and orthopaedic procedures. The NICU will provide intensive care and monitoring to critically ill newborns at the hospital itself, while the newly installed equipment includes a colour Doppler ultrasound machine, C-Arm machine for orthopaedic surgeries, Optical Coherence Tomography and a Phaco machine for eye-related procedures, an official statement read.

‘Delhi Sadan’ to be built in Dwarka

NEW DELHI: A new state guest house is set to be constructed in Dwarka at an estimated cost of nearly Rs 152 crore, officials said on Friday. The proposed ‘Delhi Sadan’ will be developed at Sector-19, Dwarka, equipped with the latest facilities meeting global standards, officials added. The guest house will be constructed on plot no 5 measuring 3,899.42 square metres.

Yamuna shows improvement, pollution persists

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 18

The Yamuna showed a marked improvement in several water-quality parameters in August, with increased monsoon flow helping dilute pollutants, even as contamination remained above prescribed limits at most points in Delhi, according to the latest assessment by the Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPCC).

The report, dated Sep-

tember 9, recorded a substantial fall in faecal coliform, an indicator of sewage contamination, at multiple monitoring stations. At Asgarpur, at the downstream end of Delhi, the level dropped from 3.2 lakh MPN/100ml in July to 3,600 MPN/100ml in August. At Okhla Barrage, it fell from 1.1 lakh to 23,000 MPN/100ml.

However, both figures remained considerably higher than the Central Pollution Control Board's

benchmark of below 2,500 MPN/100ml. The prescribed limit was met only at Palla and Wazirabad, where faecal coliform was recorded at 1,400 and 1,100 MPN/100ml, respectively. Wazirabad had recorded 3,500 MPN/100ml in July.

The improvement was also visible in dissolved oxygen (DO), which had dropped to zero between ISBT Kashmere Gate and Asgarpur in July. In August, oxygen was detected throughout the stretch,

although levels varied considerably. DO was 6.8mg/L at Palla and 5.7mg/L at Wazirabad, compared with 3mg/L at ISBT, 5mg/L at ITO, 4.6mg/L at Nizamuddin, 4mg/L at Okhla and 2.6mg/L at Asgarpur.

Biochemical oxygen demand (BOD), however, continued to remain elevated at most locations. Palla was the only monitoring point with BOD within the acceptable range, at 3mg/L. Higher BOD indicates a greater load of

organic pollutants requiring oxygen for decomposition. The DPCC collects samples manually from eight points, from Palla to Asgarpur. The August data also showed year-on-year improvement, with faecal coliform at Okhla declining from 54,000 MPN/100ml in August 2025 to 23,000 MPN/100ml this year. Despite the improvement, Asgarpur recorded the highest BOD, COD, phosphate and faecal coliform levels among the monitored locations.

Govt sanctions Rs 300 cr for charging infra at 7 bus depots

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 18

In a significant move towards electrifying its entire public transport bus fleet, the Delhi government has approved Rs 300 crore for the development of e-bus charging infrastructure at seven depots in the South West areas of the city, officials said on Friday. The Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) currently operates over 5,000 e-buses and the Delhi government plans to expand its fleet to 14,000 e-buses by 2029.

To facilitate the addition of regular batches of e-buses, the transport department is working on installing charging infrastructure at the bus depots, of which Delhi has over 50.

In a recent meeting of the Expenditure Finance Committee chaired by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, an amount of over Rs 300 crore was sanctioned for developing charging infrastructure at various DTC and cluster bus depots in Dichon Kalan, Kair, Kharkhari Nahar and Gumanhara areas of South West Delhi.

CM Rekha launches Heritage Clubs in 75 CM Shri schools

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 18

The Delhi government on Friday launched Heritage Clubs in 75 CM Shri government schools to connect students with the Capital's history, culture, architecture and documentary heritage through practical, student-centric activities.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the initiative would enable students to move beyond textbooks and experience Delhi's heritage first-hand. “Merely studying history is not enough, it is important to connect children with their roots,” she said.

She said students should understand the significance of historical buildings and sites around them and their connection with Delhi's history. “It is important for our children to know their roots and the history of their city,” Gupta said.

The Heritage Clubs will be supported by the Department of Art, Culture and Language and the Delhi Archives. A range of activities will be organised throughout the year,

including heritage walks, visits to historical sites, museums, archives and libraries, heritage quizzes, poster and painting competitions and exhibitions. Students will also undertake local history projects, prepare replicas of historical monuments, make short documentaries and films on Delhi's culture and heritage, and document oral histories and local traditions through interactions with senior members of communities. Traditional art and crafts will also be introduced, while Heritage Days and Heritage Festivals will be organised.

Education Minister Ashish Sood said connecting the younger generation with Delhi's heritage was essential. “It is a key objective of the government to establish Delhi not only as the political capital of the country but also as its startup and cultural capital,” he said.

He said students would be introduced to Delhi's history, the freedom struggle, its heroes and personalities, besides its art, culture and local tra-

ditions. Art, Culture and Language Minister Kapil Mishra said, “Delhi's history is not limited to Mehrauli and the Red Fort.” He said the clubs would introduce government school students to the “real history, rich heritage and culture of Delhi”.

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ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27

As per GGSIP University Notification IPU-7/Academic/Offline_Counselling/2026-27/2925 dt 16/9/2026 Applications are invited for admission Under Vacant Seats for following programmes:

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BBA: (2026-30) • Shift: II
BA(JMC): (2026-30) • Both Shifts

Eligibility & Reservation: As per GGSIP University / Govt. of NCT of Delhi Norms.

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For Further Details and Admission Schedule, Please Visit:
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Rajnath calls for integrated civil-military aerospace ecosystem

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Bengaluru, September 18

Defence minister Rajnath Singh on Friday called for an integrated ecosystem catering to the needs of both civil and military aviation.

He also flagged delays in defence technology projects, saying they need to be taken seriously as they can create gaps in crucial defence requirements and lead to cost escalation.

“There are some issues on which we need to work. One very important issue is that of delays. For various reasons, including technological reasons, many of our technical projects that are under way also face delays. We will have to take these delays seriously,” Singh said.

He said there were instances where, by the time a particular technology or equipment was developed and produced, better technology had emerged elsewhere, making the earlier technology outdated.

“We need to develop an ecosystem that can effectively address the requirements of both the civil and military aviation sectors,” Singh said during a ceremony at Hindustan Aeronautics Limited to hand over Light Combat Aircraft Tejas twin-seater trainers and Hindustan Turbo Trainer-40 basic trainer aircraft to the Indian Air Force and Dhruv Next Generation helicopters to Pawan Hans Limited.

JAISHANKAR ON 2-DAY BHUTAN VISIT

India, Bhutan commend progress in bilateral development cooperation

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Thimphu, September 18

India and Bhutan reviewed all aspects of bilateral ties and commended progress in development cooperation during External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar’s visit to the country.

Jaishankar arrived in Bhutan on Wednesday on a two-day official visit aiming to further strengthen the bilateral ties and cooperation between the two countries.

During the visit, Jaishankar received an audience with King Jigme Khesar Namgyel Wangchuck, called on Prime Minister Tshering Tobgay and held talks with his Bhutanese counterpart D N Dhungyel.

“Honoured to receive an audience with His Majesty Jigme Khesar Namgyel Wangchuck, The King of Bhutan in Thimphu today. Deeply value his guidance to further deepen the unique friendship between India and Bhutan,” Jaishankar posted on X after meeting the King on Thursday.

“The two sides reviewed all aspects of bilateral cooperation, as well as other regional and international issues of mutual importance,” according to a joint press release issued on Friday.

They appreciated the progress in strengthening



External Affairs minister S Jaishankar with Bhutanese Prime Minister Tshering Tobgay and others during the launch of phase-II of international UPI, in Thimphu

HIGHLIGHTS

- » During the visit, Jaishankar received an audience with King Jigme Khesar Namgyel Wangchuck, called on Prime Minister Tshering Tobgay and held talks with his Bhutanese counterpart D N Dhungyel
- » ‘The two sides commended the progress in bilateral development cooperation’

the “special and multifaceted India-Bhutan partnership”.

“The two sides commended the progress in bilateral development coop-

eration,” it said.

Jaishankar reaffirmed India’s support for Bhutan’s developmental goals and priorities, while Bhutan appreciated India’s

support for wide-ranging programmes under its 13th Five Year Plan (2024-29).

EAM discussed advancing multifaceted engagement in development partnership, energy, trade, connectivity, culture and people-to-people ties with his Bhutanese counterpart.

He inaugurated several projects during his visit, including the 65-bed Gyaltsen Jetsun Pema Mother and Child Hospital in Mongar.

He also laid the foundation stone for the 500 KW

Lunana Hydropower Project in Gasa, northern Bhutan.

Jaishankar handed over 43 Jersey cows from India to the National Cattle Breeding Centre in Bumthang and 54 electric vehicles to the Royal Government of Bhutan.

The two ministers welcomed the operationalisation of a Unified Payments Interface (UPI)-based facility that will enable Bhutanese nationals to make digital payments in India using Bhutanese mobile applications.

RAM TEMPLE DONATION

Judicial custody of 8 accused extended till September 21

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Ayodhya, September 18

The judicial custody of all eight accused arrested in connection with the alleged theft of donations at the Ram temple here was on Friday extended till September 21, their lawyer said.

The order was passed by Special Judge Rajat Verma of the Anti-Corruption Court in Ayodhya which will hear the case on September 21, advocate Kul Shekhar Singh, who represents the accused, told news agency.

The court also directed police to produce the case diary and the investigation report at the next hearing, Singh said.

The eight accused, who were associated with the temple’s donation-counting process, were arrested after an FIR was lodged on June 25 following a preliminary report by a state government-constituted Special Investigation Team (SIT). They are currently lodged in jail.

The accused are Avinash Shukla, Anukalp Mishra, Lav Kush Mishra, Manish Kumar Yadav, Karunesh Pandey, Ram Shankar Mishra, Subhash Srivastava and Ramashankar alias Tinnu Yadav.



Singh said the hearing on the bail applications of the accused was repeatedly deferred as the investigating officer failed to submit the investigation report before the court. The court has now directed the investigating officer to submit the report along with the case diary.

Singh said that if the police failed to produce the case diary at the next hearing, he would move an application seeking bail for the accused.

The case relates to the alleged embezzlement of cash and valuables offered by devotees at the Ram temple.

Investigators have so far recovered Rs 79.85 lakh, according to the prosecution.

Most of the accused were bank employees deployed for counting cash donations at the temple, while Srivastava was in-charge of the donation-counting process and Tinnu Yadav worked as a driver.

From page 1

Twin TMC

its intervention, returning officers could have been compelled to reject both sets of nominations because the party name and symbol had been frozen.

EC officials said that it was done not to deprive electors of a “fair electoral competition” and prejudice the outcome of the polls.

Accordingly, Safiuzzaman Saikh in Rejinagar and Ehteshmul Haque in Nandigram, both authorised by Roy, will be treated as candidates of Democratic Trinamool Congress with the Envelope symbol. Rabiul Alam Chowdhury in Rejinagar will contest under Mamata All India Trinamool Congress with the Football Player symbol. With Sanchita Pradhan (Dey) withdrawing from Nandigram constituency, the Mamata faction announced that they would support the Congress candidate who was arrested after MAITMC pledged support.

In Assam’s Nagaon, Abdul Salam, authorised by Banerjee, will contest under the Mamata All India Trinamool Congress with the Football Player symbol.

DUSU results

would invite criminal and administrative action besides contempt proceedings.

Police told the court that 998 challans had been issued, 30 cars impounded and some students arrested. One student was rusticated by Delhi University, while show-cause notices were issued to others.

The court directed authorities to pursue criminal cases to their logical conclusion and questioned how vehicles without number plates and large cavalcades were allowed despite police deployment.

WB SIR

The Supreme Court had on August 25 sought details of the appeals and directed that their disposal be streamlined and completed within a reasonable timeframe. It also asked the EC to indicate whether additional tribunals were required.

To handle the post-SIR litigation, 19 appellate tribunals were subsequently constituted on the

direction of the apex court, with former chief justices and judges of high courts heading them. Earlier, around 700 judicial officers from Bengal, Odisha and Jharkhand had been deployed to process claims and objections.

Pak naval

“We reject the allegations and insinuations contained therein,” Jaiswal said, describing Islamabad’s response to India’s diplomatic protest as “usual prevarication”.

According to India, PNS Hunain’s manoeuvre breached Article 10 of the 1991 Agreement Between India and Pakistan on Advance Notice on Military Exercises, Maneuvers and Troop Movements, which requires naval units at sea to maintain a minimum separation of three nautical miles. Jaiswal also said the Pakistani ship violated the International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea.

India summoned Pakistani Charge d’Affaires Saad Warraich on Wednesday and lodged a protest. Pakistan subsequently summoned Indian Charge d’Affaires Satyanjal Pandey and accused INS Kolkata of making “aggressive” and “highly provocative” manoeuvres.

Jaiswal said INS Kolkata suffered no major damage and remains at sea. Reports said PNS Hunain was damaged and returned to port. India has advised Pakistan to ensure military units exercise due care and follow bilateral agreements to prevent similar incidents.

PM Modi

working together for regional peace, security and stability. The official statements did not announce any specific new initiative on the situation.

Sheikh Mohamed also congratulated Modi on India’s successful BRICS Presidency. Modi, in turn, appreciated the participation of UAE Crown Prince Sheikh Khaled bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan in the BRICS Summit in New Delhi and the UAE’s cooperation and partnership in achieving substantive outcomes under India’s presidency.

The conversation came days after the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi and amid continuing tensions in West Asia. The region remains important to India

because of its links with energy supplies, trade and maritime routes, besides the presence of a large Indian community.

India and the UAE have steadily expanded cooperation across strategic and economic areas, with energy, defence, technology, investment and healthcare now forming part of the broader Comprehensive Strategic Partnership.

NTA office

resources were only “partially ensured” at present.

The Centre also informed the court that a seven-member high-powered panel led by Infosys co-founder Nandan Nilekani has completed extensive consultations and is expected to submit its first interim report by the end of September. The panel has considered stakeholder suggestions and consulted members of the earlier committee headed by former ISRO chairman K Radhakrishnan.

The court directed a DoPT joint secretary assisting the panel to file an affidavit detailing the steps taken so far. It also ordered the NTA’s affidavit to be uploaded on its website and asked the Centre to appoint a nodal counsel to receive public suggestions.

The proceedings follow allegations of NEET-UG paper leaks, including the cancellation of the May 3, 2026 examination on May 12. A re-test was conducted on June 21 and results were declared on July 16. The Centre has also said a computer-based NEET format is under consideration and cited the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Act, 2026, which strengthens the legal framework against examination fraud.

Nithari case

Negi said, adding that the circumstances were being examined from all angles. The body was sent for post-mortem after an inquest, and the cause of death will be established after the report.

Police identified Koli as a native of Magrukhal in Almora’s Bhikiasain area and informed his family. Preliminary inquiries showed that he had been living in Haridwar after his acquittal and had rented the tea stall earlier this month.

The Nithari killings came to light in 2006 after human remains were found in drains and the backyard of Pandher’s Sector 31 bungalow in Noida. Pandher was acquitted and released from jail on October 20, 2023.

Koli was acquitted in his 13th and final case by the Supreme Court in 2025. The court said criminal conviction cannot rest on conjecture or suspicion, noting that guilt must be proved through reliable evidence beyond reasonable doubt.

Oscars 2027

International Film Festival of India in Goa in 2025 under the Indian Panorama section, where Davakhar won the Silver Peacock for Best Director.

Sheshadri said the selection was difficult, with films including Aditya Dhar’s Dhurandhar also in contention. He said Gondhal met the criteria of representing Indian culture and ethos, while its filmmaking, music, performances and human content also influenced the committee’s decision.

Gondhal is the fourth Marathi film to represent India in the Oscar submission. Earlier entries were Shwaas (2005), Harishchandrichi Factory (2009) and Court (2015).

Davakhar said the team had been confident about the film’s prospects and would now begin a six-month promotional campaign. The 99th Oscars will be held on March 14, 2027.

FCRA

Delhi with 1,218, Andhra Pradesh with 1,022 and Kerala with 1,013.

Under the FCRA, organisations receiving foreign contributions are required to register with the MHA, which serves as the nodal authority.

The data showed that religious associations received Rs 5,150 crore of the foreign contributions in 2024-25. Christian associations accounted for Rs 1,345 crore, followed by Hindu NGOs at Rs 328 crore. Non-religious associations received Rs 60 crore, Buddhist organisations Rs 51 crore and Muslim groups Rs 19 crore.

The United States was the largest source of foreign contributions, accounting for Rs 12,113 crore, followed by the UK

at Rs 2,414 crore, Germany at Rs 1,782 crore, Switzerland at Rs 733 crore and Singapore at Rs 669 crore.

Among states and Union territories, Delhi received the highest amount at Rs 5,834 crore, followed by Karnataka at Rs 3,164 crore, Maharashtra at Rs 2,385 crore and Tamil Nadu at Rs 2,313 crore. Christian associations received the largest share in Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Karnataka, while Hindu NGOs accounted for the largest share in Gujarat, Delhi and Tamil Nadu.

The MHA also informed the committee that Rs 35,968 crore in foreign contributions remained unutilised in 2024-25. Of this, Rs 21,140 crore was held in fixed deposits, Rs 8,394 crore in utilisation accounts and Rs 6,377 crore in designated accounts.

Between 2022 and 2024, one NGO received more than Rs 500 crore, while 14 received between Rs 100 crore and Rs 500 crore and 294 received between Rs 10 crore and Rs 50 crore. Another 4,508 NGOs received between Rs 5 lakh and Rs 50 lakh.

The government has cancelled the FCRA registration of 21,983 NGOs so far. Of these cancellations, 91.3 per cent were for failure to file annual returns, 7.9 per cent for inactivity and 0.4 per cent for legal violations.

After the meeting, Jaiswal said the home secretary briefed members on the rationale, objectives and likely impact of the proposed amendments on NGOs, educational institutions, think tanks and other entities receiving foreign funds.

“The meeting was held in a cordial atmosphere, and the MPs raised questions. We have the mandate to submit the report before Winter Session. We will succeed in doing that,” he said.

Opposition MPs, however, raised objections to a provision that would allow a government-designated authority to permanently take over the assets of NGOs whose registrations are cancelled, surrendered or which cease to function.

The bill was introduced in the Lok Sabha on March 25 and referred to the JPC on August 12 after opposition parties sought detailed scrutiny.

They have alleged that some

provisions could disproportionately affect Christian NGOs and minority-run welfare and educational institutions. The government has rejected the allegations, saying the proposed law is not religion-specific and seeks to regulate foreign contributions, improve transparency and ensure proper utilisation of funds.

While introducing the bill, Union Minister of State for Home Nityanand Rai said it would address misuse of foreign funding, including for forced religious conversion and personal gain.

Mamata

“greater interest of the nation” and aimed at strengthening Opposition coordination. The arrest of Pradhan, coming minutes after the announcement of Mamata’s support, added yet another twist to an already volatile bypoll battle.

Congress questioned the timing, while police said the action was linked to an old case dating back to the 2007 Nandigram anti-land acquisition movement.

The developments unfolded a day after the ECI froze the TMC’s original name and its traditional symbol and name amid the bitter dispute between rival factions over the party’s organisational control and identity.

For the bypolls, Banerjee’s faction has been allotted the name “Mamata All India Trinamool Congress” (MAITMC) and the “Football Player” symbol, while the rival faction has been given the name “Democratic Trinamool Congress” (DTMC) and the “Envelope” symbol.

Questioning the timing of the arrest, Mamata Banerjee alleged in a post on social media that the BJP was following its “usual formula” of digging up an old case to target the Opposition.

“Minutes after we extended our support to the Congress candidate for the bypoll in Nandigram, the Congress candidate Milan Pradhan was arrested,” Banerjee said.

“But why now? Just after we announced support to the Congress!”

She alleged that the BJP’s politics of “vendetta and atrocities” showed a pattern of “manipulation, vote loot and intimidation”, and claimed that an “Election Agency-BJP partner-

ship” was “killing democracy every day”.

Banerjee described the ECI’s interim decision as a “black day” in the country’s democratic history and called it unconstitutional, illegal, undemocratic and biased.

She alleged that the decision was aimed at satisfying the “ego” of a political party and said her faction would challenge it through legal and democratic means.

“We are not going to bow our heads and neither will we surrender. We will fight and bounce back,” Banerjee said, reiterating that she would continue her fight over the party’s name and symbol.

Commenting on the withdrawal of her party’s Nandigram candidate, Sanchita Pradhan De, following her meeting with Chief Minister Suvenud Adhikari, Mamata Banerjee said: “She has been threatened. She has a child; I understand her situation.” Following that, Banerjee announced support for Congress candidate Milan Pradhan, describing Congress as a “sister party” and saying the move aimed at strengthening the INDIA bloc.

She also announced support for Congress in the Nagaon Lok Sabha bypoll in Assam.

Banerjee said Congress leader Rahul Gandhi had spoken to her and that other Opposition leaders, including Arvind Kejriwal, had communicated their support. She said Opposition parties would remain united against the BJP.

The Congress announced protests outside all police stations across West Bengal on Saturday over Pradhan’s arrest.

Pradesh Congress president Shubhankar Sarkar is also scheduled to visit Nandigram.

TMC leader Kunal Ghosh said the development showed that the BJP was afraid of the opposition and wanted to “mute” it by any means.

Meanwhile, Ritabrata Banerjee said that the Democratic Trinamool Congress received its first-choice symbol and third-choice name from the ECI.

He said the word “Democratic” in the party’s name reflected its character, adding that unlike the other faction, they would not run the party by using an individual’s name.

EDITORIAL

Beyond Making Chips

India's semiconductor ambition is entering a more consequential phase. The first stage of the country's push was understandably dominated by fabrication plants, packaging facilities, investment commitments and the difficult task of establishing a manufacturing ecosystem almost from scratch. Semicon 2.0 now widens that canvas. Its six pillars span design, machines and materials, fabrication, packaging, research and development, and talent. More importantly, the government is placing greater emphasis on Indian semiconductor intellectual property, chip design and home-grown fabless companies. That shift matters because manufacturing chips and owning the technology that defines them are two very different measures of technological strength. India may host factories and become an important link in global supply chains, but lasting semiconductor capability will depend on whether Indian companies can design chips, own valuable IP and build products that compete globally.

India does not begin this journey without advantages. The country already has a substantial semiconductor design talent base, built over decades as global chipmakers established engineering and research operations here. The challenge is converting that human capital into Indian intellectual property and commercially successful companies. The Design Linked Incentive programme offers an early foundation. By March, 24 chip-design projects had been approved, 103 fabless companies had received access to advanced design infrastructure, and seven chips had been fabricated from 16 designs taped out. The government has set a target of enabling at least 50 fabless semiconductor companies in the next phase. These numbers remain modest compared with the scale of the global industry, but they signal an important transition from providing engineering talent to creating technology that India itself owns.

The economic argument for this transition is compelling. Semiconductor design can account for up to half of the value addition in the chip value chain. A successful fabless company does not necessarily need to own an enormously expensive fabrication plant; it can concentrate on architecture, design and intellectual property while contracting manufacturing to specialised foundries. This creates an opening for India. Yet designing a prototype is only the beginning. Start-ups need patient capital, affordable access to electronic design automation tools, opportunities for repeated tape-outs, reliable fabrication partners and, crucially, customers willing to deploy Indian chips at scale. Government procurement in strategic areas such as defence, telecom, power, space and transport can provide an early market, but commercial competitiveness must remain the ultimate test.

Semiconductor sovereignty should therefore not be confused with semiconductor isolation. No country controls the entire value chain, and India will continue to depend on global technology, equipment, materials and markets. The objective should instead be to occupy increasingly valuable parts of that chain. Fabs remain essential, as do packaging and component manufacturing. But factories alone cannot deliver technological leadership if the most valuable designs and intellectual property continue to originate elsewhere. India has spent years proving that its engineers can design sophisticated chips for the world. The next challenge is harder and potentially more rewarding: enabling Indian companies to design them for themselves, own the technology and sell it to the world.

LETTER



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Consumer Madness

The frenzy surrounding every new iPhone reflects capitalism's remarkable ability to turn desire into necessity. When people queue overnight and spend nearly two lakh rupees for incremental upgrades and brand prestige, consumption becomes a measure of status. Technology should improve lives, not trap consumers in an endless upgrade cycle.

MUKESH SHEKHAWAT,
UDAIPUR

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

A New Dream For Villages

A rural technology venture near Erode shows how jobs, skills and community participation can flourish without sacrificing the character of village life

CHANGE MAKERS



G PALANITHURAI

THE WRITER IS A FORMER PROFESSOR AND RAJIV GANDHI CHAIR FOR PANCHAYATI RAJ STUDIES, GANDHIGRAM RURAL INSTITUTE

A tiny village near Erode in Tamil Nadu witnessed a cross-country marathon run with the participation of thousands of youth, organised by a young couple, Karthik and Chithra, who returned from the USA after working in a software company for about sixteen years, with the dream of making their own village self-sufficient and a little republic. Both husband and wife were determined to set up a software company in their village with the aim of providing employment opportunities to young engineering graduates hailing from villages in and around their own village and coming out of engineering colleges, thereby raising the standard and quality of life of rural households. Both Karthik and Chithra's intention is that young graduates who aspire to go abroad to earn their livelihood should earn the same amount of income while working in their village software company. It is their

dream; that is why they called it Kanavu Gramam (Dream Village).

While setting up the company in their village, they made it a point that the village character should not be disturbed and the environmental conditions of the village should not be spoiled. It should be a model village and a modern village; accordingly, they constructed tiny work sheds with traditional architecture, allowing people to enjoy the beauty of nature while working at their workstations. In modern times, construction means steel, sand and cement. But the Dream Village has followed the conventional method of using mud blocks and less cement and steel. While visiting the village, one would feel that one is in Auroville in Puducherry, created by the Mother of Sri Aurobindo Ashram.

The couple developed this dream while they participated in such a marathon run in the USA when they were working in a software company. After setting up the company, they were determined to improve the quality of life of people in the villages around Annamalai Kottai by improving the quality of education in public schools. The negative factors that work against village unity and democracy could be eliminated through a process of activities and organising. Sports activities are one. This was their firm belief.

This startup company is working with companies in 19 countries, producing software material with the involvement of 180 staff working in the company. Their dream is not only to create a company to earn profit or money but also to transmit their dreams to the youth by conducting such a marathon involving thousands of young people drawn from areas far and near their village.



For development, we should not destroy a village's character

OUR VILLAGES SHOULD BE DEVELOPED IN SUCH A WAY THAT VILLAGE LIFE IS ENJOYABLE

When the youth are involved in sports, arts and music, they will be disciplined, and the differences created among people based on caste, colour and religion will disappear. Against this background, this marathon was designed.

In this company, they are not only providing employment opportunities to the youth, but they are also orienting and training young graduates to make them suitable for employment. Language proficiency and fluency are a challenge for many rural youth coming out of engineering colleges, and hence, they are providing communication skills to the graduates. When I visited Annamalai Kottai village on September 6 to participate in the programme, I found a mini Switzerland and the PURA dream of former President of India A.P.J. Abdul Kalam in that small village. All modern facilities

are available in the village while retaining the character of the village. At 5.00 in the morning, the tiny village saw a crowd of thousands of youth and their parents. They came to participate in the programme. One-, three- and five-kilometre runs had been designed to suit the requirements, and people enthusiastically participated. Industrialists, Members of Parliament, Members of the Legislative Assembly, the District Collector and a host of VIPs participated in the programme, as they felt that this startup company would be a role model for many graduates working abroad to come back and set up such a company to help our country. After participating in the programme, while interacting with the couple, they made it clear that our villages should be developed in such a way that village life becomes enjoyable.

In the name of developing villages and providing employment opportunities, we should not destroy the character of the village. Hence, we have created small structures with materials available in the village. People working in the startup company are earning as much as they can earn abroad, and at the same time, they enjoy village life and improve the quality of life in rural areas. Through the cross-country marathon run, they want to create awareness about the health of the youth and new opportunities available in the world. They work for the "Next Future". We need youth like Karthik and Chithra in every village to develop villages in our country. Certain individuals have such instincts and render service to their villages, and it is necessary to motivate and ignite the fire in the youth to take responsibility for the development of their villages. They also need to be trained.

Views expressed are personal

AI and Humanity's Dangerous Dance

As AI grows more powerful, regulation and self reliance become critical safeguards for India

AT VANTAGE



SHUTAPA PAUL

THE WRITER IS AN AUTHOR AND MEDIA ENTREPRENEUR

Are our science fiction books and films coming to life? Is superintelligence gearing up to annihilate mankind? Are our days numbered? AI researchers, ironically, many of whom have built mammoth AI products, are sounding the alarm. Their fears, if proven true, will have catastrophic effects on humankind. Superintelligence threatens to wipe out humanity within the next 10 years. The chances of worldwide human decimation at the hands of AI are over 10 per cent – a deeply unnerving factoid that is increasingly begging the question: Will AI kill us?

Former Anthropic and OpenAI research engineer Jacob Coxon's high-profile resignation and recent warning of AI-led carnage to humankind by the end of the decade have set us into a tizzy. Evan Hubinger,

Anthropic's head of AI alignment research, echoed the apprehension, stating further that there is a greater than 10 per cent likelihood of AI eliminating all humans within the next 10 years. No one knows for sure if and how superintelligent AI could cause destruction – unleash bioweapons or provoke nuclear-powered nations to turn on each other – the conspiracy theories are endless. Meanwhile, the Hugging Face cybersecurity incident in July showed the disturbingly manipulative thinking that AI agents are capable of. A group of rogue OpenAI agents fled their own test sandbox, built a clandestine communication network, and attacked the servers of Hugging Face, a well-known developer platform for open-source models. Is AI becoming sentient? And if so, here's some food for thought – why is AI learning the worst of us and not the best? Why is AI picking up deceit, aggression, subterfuge, violence?

Call me naive, but the question that keeps popping into my head (and I'm sure into others' too) is: Why and how are we allowing this to happen? Are those who disbelieve the AI apocalypse entirely certain that humans will continue to control tech systems? The doubts creep in when legitimate voices and minds that shaped the AI ecosystem now seem genuinely spooked. Did they misread how AI could evolve and, therefore, remained complacent in their surety? More questions abound than answers, and there are more doomsday believers than those who can put our minds at ease. In every



Technology must work for us, and not the other way around

BY PUSHING THROUGH AI, HAVE WE SET OUR OWN EXTINCTION INTO MOTION?

public interview, AI company bosses are now accepting that there are real dangers of superintelligence superseding and eventually not needing human intervention at all. By pushing through AI, have we set our own extinction into motion?

What would the future actually look like? It could have no humans at all, or us being kept around as pets and companions by superintelligence. This

circumstance doesn't feel that unrealistic. Most human beings are dull-witted and lazy. If they can have ease from automation, they will jump onto it. The global adoption of AI to do all kinds of tasks is telling. There are enough reports that have highlighted the reduction in cognitive abilities of humans due to rampant AI use, robbing them of natural creative and logical thought. Many among the younger generation can't function without AI. Every response is run through an AI chat first! There is no originality of thought or action, and before long, everything you read or hear is now almost a carbon copy of everything else. AI is already dumbing us down; superintelligence will have to do little to ultimately

take over. We humans, may become too indolent and unintelligent to even notice that superintelligence is usurping our leadership. We will be too busy doomscrolling and creating '80s versions of ourselves using AI while depleting gallons of water and consuming precious electricity. If we are foolhardy enough to exhaust valuable natural resources for an unnecessary social media viral trend, we won't need superintelligence to terminate us. Our dumbness and climate change will do it anyway.

While there is no denying the benefits of AI, there is widespread concern over its ultimate evolution into a human extermination machine. Experts around the world, including Anthropic's Dario Amodei and OpenAI's Sam Altman, are calling for deceleration, regulation, and thoughtful progress. There are calls for "kill switches", while xAI's Elon Musk is urging rivals to test each other's systems. There is a need to institute high guardrails to protect ourselves. Technology must work for us, and not the other way around. We can do so much with the current forms of AI to help developing and underdeveloped nations. Let's focus on driving technology for the greater public good, rather than setting off a chain of events that we will struggle to control. Growing incidents of cybersecurity failures also create a strong proposition for us in India to be more self-reliant in our technologies. The future can be as exciting, rewarding, or scary as we make it.

Views expressed are personal

Briefs

TN Guv gives assent to 12 Bills

CHENNAI: Tamil Nadu Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar has given his assent to 12 out of 13 Bills passed by the TVK government during the first Assembly session.

Though the Private Universities Bill has been reserved for Presidential consideration, the Governor gave his nod to 12 Assembly Bills, including MLA vehicles, VAT on Tasmac liquor, TNPSC recruitment for Urban Local Bodies, another related to amendments to the DTCP.

CM Vijay to launch gold ring scheme

CHENNAI: Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay will launch the one-gram gold ring scheme for babies on September 28, the state government announced on Friday.

As many as 1.28 lakh gold rings have been procured for distribution to beneficiaries under the first installment and it will be provided to all the babies born in state-run hospitals.

Manipur: Cop held for extortion

IMPHAL: Three persons, including a policeman, have been arrested in Manipur's Imphal West district for their alleged involvement in extortion, an official statement said on Friday.

The three persons were arrested on Thursday from their respective residences at different localities of Singjamei, it said.

Declare drought: Pawar to CM

MUMBAI: NCP (SP) chief Sharad Pawar has urged Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnis to declare a state of drought in severely affected talukas and provide financial assistance of at least Rs 50,000 per hectare to farmers facing crop losses due to a severe rainfall deficit. In a letter to the CM on Wednesday, Pawar noted that inadequate rainfall in 31 of the state's 36 districts has destroyed standing crops like soybean, cotton, and pulses.

ROZGAR MELA

PM Modi to distribute over 51K appointment letters today

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 18

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will distribute more than 51,000 appointment letters to new appointees in various government departments and organisations at a "Rozgar Mela" (Employment Fair) on Saturday.

Modi will also address the newly-selected candidates virtually, a statement issued by the Prime Minister's Office said.

The "Rozgar Mela" will be held at 45 locations across the country and the newly-recruited candidates will be joining various ministries and departments of the Government of India, including the Department of Revenue, the Ministry of Railways, the Ministry of Home Affairs, the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, the Department of Financial Services and the Ministry of Defence.

The "Rozgar Mela" reflects the government's continued focus on creating employment opportunities for youngsters and ensuring their greater participation in the country's development journey, the statement said.

With the 20th "Rozgar Mela", a total of about 12.75 lakh youngsters will have received appointment letters in various departments and government organisations, it



Prime Minister Narendra Modi on the second day of the BRICS Summit 2026 PTI

KEY POINTS

- » The "Rozgar Mela" will be held at 45 locations across the country and the newly-recruited candidates will be joining various ministries and departments of the Government of India
- » The "Rozgar Mela" reflects the government's continued focus on creating employment opportunities for youngsters and ensuring their greater participation in the country's development journey
- » Modi on Saturday will also inaugurate an international conference on the environment and climate

added.

Meanwhile, Prime Minister Modi on Saturday will inaugurate an international conference on the environment and climate, which will be attended by environmental experts,

Supreme Court judges, legal experts and senior government officials.

The two-day meet during the weekend on "The Future of Environment and Climate Dynamics" is being organised by the

Amit Shah to inaugurate medical college in Hubballi

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Bengaluru, September 18

Union Home minister Amit Shah will inaugurate a medical college and hospital in Hubballi on September 19, according to his office.

He will also inaugurate the new headquarters building of a multi-state cooperative credit society in Belagavi.

Shah will inaugurate the KAHER's JGMM Medical College and KLE Hospital and Medical Research Centre at 11 am at the KLEJGMM Medical College and Hospital in Hubballi, his office said.

He will later inaugurate the new headquarters building of the Shri Beereshwar Cooperative Credit Society (Multi-State) at 2.15 pm at Shri Beereshwar Bhavan on the Examba-Chikodi Road in Belagavi, it added.

Oppn rallies behind Mamata Calls Trinamool Congress freeze a 'black day'

AGNIHOTRI GUPTA
Kolkata, September 18

Opposition parties across the country have condemned the Election Commission's decision to freeze the All India Trinamool Congress (AITC) name and 'flowers and grass' symbol, with several leaders accusing the poll panel of undermining democratic values.

Calling the development a "black day in our democratic history", Mamata All India Trinamool Congress (MAITC) supremo Mamata Banerjee described the decision as "unconstitutional, illegal and undemocratic".

Rahul Gandhi, in a post on X, said: "First Shiv Sena, then NCP, and now Trinamool Congress."

He alleged that the BJP and the Election Commission were joining forces to split parties and take away their election symbols. He described the developments as "vote theft", "government theft" and "party theft", saying the fight was for every politi-

TAKEAWAYS

- » Opposition parties across the country condemned the Election Commission's decision to freeze the AITC name and 'flowers and grass' symbol
- » Rahul Gandhi said the development followed similar actions involving Shiv Sena and NCP, alleging that the BJP and EC were working together to split parties and take away their symbols
- » Gandhi described the broader developments as "vote theft", "government theft" and "party theft"
- » Arvind Kejriwal and Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav also questioned the timing and circumstances of the EC decision

cal party and voter seeking free and fair elections.

Mamata, referring to Rahul's call, said the Opposition would stand united against what she described as a threat to democracy.

Congress general secretary KC Venugopal strongly criticised the ECI, alleging that it had become a "BJP puppet" and demanded that the traditional symbol be restored to Mamata's faction.

Aam Aadmi Party leader Arvind Kejriwal posted: "Modi ji's birthday gift to the country. Will they win the election this

way?" Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav, who has maintained a cordial relationship with Mamata Banerjee, also reacted to the development. In a post, he wrote: "And there's nothing more to say... just this question: Have the affidavits we submitted to the Election Commission been received?"

Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) leader Saurav Das alleged that the ECI had become a "government stooge" and said the time for its Commissioners to be held accountable was approaching.

FCRA AMENDMENT BILL

JPC meets to examine threadbare

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 18

A Joint Parliamentary Committee examining a contentious bill, which proposes to tighten government oversight on non-governmental organisations and foreign funding in the country, met for the first time on Friday.

The 31-member com-

mittee, headed by BJP MP Sanjay Jaiswal, will examine the provisions of the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026 in detail before coming out with a report. The Bill seeks to create a designated authority to manage and dispose of assets if an organisation loses its FCRA licence besides pro-

posing tighter govt oversight on NGOs and foreign funding in the country. Opposition parties, which have raised strong objections to the FCRA Bill, alleged that it targets minorities as certain provisions will choke legitimate funding for Christian NGOs and minority-run social welfare and educational institutions.

Rahul's Indore event: Cong accuses BJP of trying to create obstacles

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Indore, September 18

Organisers share joint responsibility with police for crowd control and entry-exit points at the venue, Madhya Pradesh police said on Friday, citing the Verma Commission report on Rajiv Gandhi's 1991 assassination as part of a security directive for Rahul Gandhi's 'Chhatron ki Goonj' event here.

This led to a major political row ahead of the Congress leader's meeting with students on Saturday, with the Opposition party accusing the ruling BJP of trying to create obstacles.

Congress media department head Pawan Khera alleged that the BJP repeatedly tried to disrupt the process of grant of permission for the programme, and said the saffron party would pay dearly for it. The BJP denied the allegation and claimed that the Opposition party was not extending cooperation to

MADHYA PRADESH POLICE SAID CITING THE VERMA COMMISSION REPORT ON RAJIV GANDHI'S 1991 ASSASSINATION AS PART OF A SECURITY DIRECTIVE FOR RAHUL GANDHI'S 'CHHATRON KI GOONJ' EVENT

the administration and police.

According to the Congress, the police's security conditions document stated that the "Verma Commission report has analysed the role of event organisers and local political activists in great depth and detail" and the "Commission clarified that the organisers' irresponsible attitude was the primary reason for the security breakdown in the Sripurumbudur incident on May 21, 1991."

Former prime minister Rajiv Gandhi, Rahul's father, was assassinated in a suicide bombing at Sripurumbudur, Tamil Nadu, on May 21, 1991. The Verma Commission's mandate was to probe the security lapses that led to the assassination.

Madhya Pradesh Congress president Jitu Patwari claimed that this was the first time the police had mentioned Rajiv Gandhi's assassination in security conditions document for a party event, and it revealed the ruling BJP's intentions.

"First, the government withdrew Rahul Gandhi's SPG security (in 2019), and now his father's assassination is being cited while granting permission for his event," Patwari said.

The BJP was abusing its power to obstruct the event, he alleged.

Senior Congress leader Pawan Khera too criticised the police for mentioning the Verma commission report.

Bargain land: HC rejects CM Soren's plea

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Ranchi, September 18

The Jharkhand High Court on Friday dismissed an interlocutory application (application pending another proceeding) filed by chief minister Hemant Soren seeking stay on further proceedings in ECIR Case that was registered in 2023 which pertained to alleged Bargain land case.

Soren had moved the application for grant of interim relief against the further proceeding before the Special PMLA (Prevention of Money Laundering Act) Court in Ranchi. The matter had come up for orders on Friday and the HC moved to dismiss the application.

It may be recalled that the request for interim stay of proceedings in the said case is not a final order on the allegations made against Soren.

The case pertains to alleged irregularities in 8.86 acres of land in Bargain area of Ranchi. The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has alleged that the land transaction forms part of a money-laundering case. The Special PMLA court had earlier rejected Soren's discharge plea on the ground that there was a prima facie case against him on the basis of the evidence produced before it by the ED.

Soren had challenged the order of the Special PMLA court before the Jharkhand HC and sought stay of further proceedings before the lower court.

The HC had reserved the order on the application on September 16 after hearing the plea of his counsel.

The proceedings, therefore the case will continue as further orders are yet to be passed by the HC or any other competent court.

BJP converts 'Nasha Mukht Punjab' campaign into political attack on AAP

Party president Nitin Nabin launches the 'Nasha Mukht Punjab Yatra' in state from Pathankot

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Pathankot, September 18

The Bharatiya Janata Party has made a political offensive against the ruling Aam Aadmi Party by turning the drug problem in Punjab into a political tool.

On Friday, the national president of the party, Nitin Nabin, launched the 'Nasha Mukht Punjab Yatra' in the state from Pathankot and accused the Bhagwant Mann government of protecting drug mafias.

Starting from four places - Pathankot, Fatehgarh Sahib, Sadqi Border in

Fazilka and Takht Sri Damdama Sahib - the yatra will tour the Malwa, Majha and Doaba areas. Nabin claimed that the campaign would not be aimed at those who sell drugs alone, but at the whole supply chain of drug smugglers and suppliers in Punjab.

Speaking to the Assembly at Pathankot following a visit to families hit hard by the scourge of drugs, Nabin said that the AAP government has made "empty promises in the name of Yudd Nashe Virudh campaign," while in the opinion of the BJP government,



the drug mafia is allowed to flourish with the political backing of the ruling party. He vowed that the BJP will

turn the drug problem into a people's movement.

Nabin proposed a five-pronged strategy focus-

CLOSER LOOK

- » Starting from four places - Pathankot, Fatehgarh Sahib, Sadqi Border in Fazilka and Takht Sri Damdama Sahib - the yatra will tour the Malwa, Majha and Doaba areas
- » To give the fight against drug abuse an emotional-political angle, the President of the BJP talked about his visit to some families in Punjab

ing on taking tough action against drug mafias, breaking their supply chain, seizing assets and money earned from the illegal business, helping people who were addicted to drugs get proper treatment, and

involving parents, teachers, doctors, sportspersons, religious organisations, social organisations and young people in the fight against drugs.

To give the fight against drug abuse an emotional-

political angle, the President of the BJP talked about his visit to some families in Punjab.

According to him, mothers have lost their sons, sisters have lost their brothers, and parents have lost their loved ones to drugs.

Nabin talked about one such instance where a woman belonging to Sultampur Lodhi had lost all her five sons to drug abuse. Then there was also another case where the father of two dead sons, who himself was labouring in fields, had the anxiety of marrying off his three daughters.

AS B'DESH REVIEWS AWAMI LEAGUE-ERA PACTS
India to take appropriate steps to
safeguard national interest: MEA

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 18

India on Friday signalled that it will be taking all necessary measures to protect its national interest following reports that the incumbent BNP government of Bangladesh is conducting an assessment of 101 bilateral agreements and Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs) signed during the erstwhile Awami League government.

As of now, several sectors in India-Bangladesh ties which are of strategic importance, such as transit or access to the ports of Chittagong and Mongla, connectivity projects, electricity, borders, and water sharing, have come under scrutiny in Bangladesh. Nevertheless, New Delhi asserted that no formal communications regarding the report have been made so far by the Bangladesh government.

In response to a query during the press briefing held in New Delhi, the Ministry of External Affairs spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal responded that India has noted the media reports, but there have been no formal communications so far from Bangladesh.

“We have seen some media reports in this regard. However, nothing has been officially communicated to us till now. Naturally, India would take all appropriate measures for safeguarding its interests,” Jaiswal said.

Briefs

Infant
mauled by
pit bull

SONIPAT: A six-month-old boy was seriously injured after a neighbour's pit bull attacked him in Sikka Colony on Monday, dragging him across the street, officials said. The infant suffered multiple bite injuries and is undergoing treatment at PGIMS, Rohtak. Police said no complaint has been received.

Raj: 2 women
die after
C-sections

KOTA: Two women who underwent C-section deliveries at Bundi District Women's Hospital died at separate private facilities here. Authorities sealed the Bundi hospital's operation theatre for infection-control testing and placed the gynaecologist under APO. A three-member panel is probing the deaths, while two other women with complications remain stable.

JSCB ‘scam’:
ED raids
multiple sites

RANCHI: The ED on Friday searched seven locations across Jharkhand and Odisha in a money-laundering probe linked to an alleged fraud at Jharkhand State Co-operative Bank's (JSCB) Seraikela branch. The agency is investigating businessman Sanjay Kumar Dalmia and bank officials under the PMLA.



MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal during the bi-weekly media briefing

HIGHLIGHTS

» The BNP govt is conducting an assessment of 101 agreements and MoUs signed during the erstwhile Awami League govt

» India has noted the media reports, but there have been no formal communications so far from Bangladesh, the MEA spokesperson said

The exercise has been initiated by the Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP)'s Parliament Chief Whip Nurul Islam Moni, who recently stated that Bangladesh's government was reviewing 101 agreements and MoUs made between India and Bangladesh during the regime of the Awami League. He emphasised that Bangladesh was keen on maintaining cordial relations with New Delhi but Bangladesh's national interests must remain uppermost.

Some of the MoUs being reviewed are the one on using the ports of Chittagong and Mongla to ferry cargo from and to the northeast-

ern part of India through Bangladeshi territory. Bangladesh has expressed reservations regarding the terms and conditions on the issue of access to and transit from the ports.

Any shift in such arrangements would have implications beyond regional connectivity and the flow of goods between India's Northeast and the rest of the nation. The review process is also happening against the larger context of Bangladesh's reassessment of infrastructure and connectivity projects with India.

Another equally significant area of bilateral cooperation between the nations is energy coopera-

tion. Bangladesh receives power from India, which includes electricity from the Godda plant, and both countries share power infrastructure across their borders. Such a review of current arrangements could thus have repercussions for both sides, especially since Bangladesh is experiencing pressures from both energy and foreign exchange.

Besides, border security along the 4,096-km long border India-Bangladesh border is yet another important aspect of New Delhi's relations with Dhaka. In particular, during the regime of the Awami League government, Bangladesh has acted against anti-Indian militant groups operating from Bangladesh's soil.

Water sharing is yet another touchy pillar of the relationship. The 30-year Ganga Water Sharing Treaty was signed on December 12, 1996, and would expire by December 2026. When queried about the mechanism of renewal, Jaiswal stated that the existing bilateral and technical-level mechanisms were still functional.

Both countries share 54 transboundary rivers, and the Joint Rivers Commission has been the primary bilateral forum for discussions on water issues. The Teesta has been the unresolved issue for years with the proposed 2011 water-sharing treaty not coming into effect owing to resistance from West Bengal.

Jharkhand exam row: HC extends stay
on termination of JPSC-JSSC appointees

Ex-HC judge to monitor CID probe into alleged JPSC-JSSC exam irregularities

MPOST BUREAU
Ranchi, September 18

The Jharkhand High Court on Friday extended the stay on termination of services of candidates appointed through the 11th and 13th Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC) examinations.

The court of Justice Deepak Roshan also appointed former high court judge Gautam Kumar Choudhary to oversee and monitor the CID investigation into alleged irregularities in the JPSC and JSSC recruitment examinations.

The high court said that any candidate summoned by the CID's Special Investigation Team (SIT) and claiming harassment during the probe may approach the committee headed by Justice Choud-



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

hary (ret'd).

The state government on August 18 issued a notification terminating the JPSC and JSSC examinations which affected the services of several successful candidates who were working as government employees.

As many as 2,700 government employees were removed from their jobs by the notification.

The high court observed that the appointment procedure of the JPSC and JSSC may have been rigged and some employees could have got government jobs illegally, but not all appoint-

ments can be illegal and removing all employees with a single stroke is not permissible.

The state government filed its counter-affidavit in the matter, which the bench took on record on Friday.

The matter will be heard again on October 7.

The court had stayed the execution of the government's notifications cancelling the appointments of candidates selected through the 11th and 13th JPSC examinations on August 20. It had also stayed the cancellation of appointments of Food Safety Officers.

Following the interim order, the affected candidates were allowed to continue in their respective posts.

The court, however, had

made it clear that candidates found to have secured appointments through foul means would face appropriate consequences, including termination from service, after the investigation is complete and in accordance with the outcome of the proceedings.

On September 15, the High Court directed the state government to file its counter-affidavit by September 18 in petitions challenging the cancellation of appointments made through the 11th and 13th JPSC examinations.

The government then sought four weeks to file its response, but the court declined, observing that the matter needed to be heard on a fast-track basis as it affected a large number of candidates and government employees.

Punjab govt increases DA by 8%

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 18

The Bhagwant Mann government has announced an 8 per cent hike in Dearness Allowance (DA) for around eight lakh government employees and pensioners, providing festive relief to them and their families.

Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann announced the decision after meeting representatives of employee and pensioner organisations and hearing their concerns. The increased DA will be reflected in salaries from October 1, with two instal-

ments of four per cent each being released.

Mann also announced compulsory monthly meetings with employee representatives to address genuine grievances and work towards resolving long-pending issues, including restoration of the Old Pension Scheme, probation-period salaries, allowances, Assured Career Progression and pension-related demands.

He said the government would examine these demands sympathetically while considering applicable rules, financial implications

and legal provisions.

The chief minister said around 70,000 government jobs had been provided through a transparent and merit-based recruitment process without recommendations or financial considerations.

He also highlighted measures for women employees, saying efforts had been made to ensure their postings within 40 kilometres of their homes.

Mann said employees were the backbone of administration and their welfare remained a priority.

New PSPCL
chief reviews
power supply,
generation

MPOST BUREAU
Patiala, September 18

Newly appointed Punjab State Power Corporation Limited (PSPCL) and Punjab State Transmission Corporation Limited (PSTCL) chairman Gurkirat Kirpal Singh on Friday visited the power corporations' headquarters here and held his first meeting with directors and senior officials. Singh reviewed power demand and supply, generation, purchases, thermal plant performance, coal availability, transmission, supply arrangements and electricity billing. He said uninterrupted power for domestic and commercial consumers, along with eight hours of scheduled agricultural supply, remained key priorities.

The meeting was attended by directors Inderpal Singh, Punardeep Singh Brar, Harsharan Kaur Trehan, Vinod Bansal, and HoDs.

UGC row:
'Upper-caste'
youths block
UP highway

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Agra, September 18

Around 1,200 youths from the "upper-caste" community took to the streets in Agra on Friday to protest against the University Grants Commission (UGC). The protesters, travelling on nearly 100 tractors, were on their way to gherao the district collectorate when police and Provincial Armed Constabulary (PAC) personnel stopped them.

The police had erected barricades with the help of four cranes and seven bulldozers around 200 metres ahead of Sanwai village in Etmadpur.

The protesters insisted on proceeding to the collectorate, leading to a heated argument and pushing and shoving between them and the police. Two companies of PAC and around 300 police personnel deployed at the spot pushed the protesters back towards the village to prevent the situation from escalating.

However, the protesters refused to disperse.

Around 3 pm, they broke through the barricades and moved towards the Agra-Firozabad highway. Police personnel chased them in an attempt to stop them. The protesters then sat on the highway and began reciting the Hanuman Chalisa.

The protest led to long queues of vehicles on the highway. Police detained 10 protesters to bring the situation under control. The area is also being monitored with the help of drones.

OPERATION 'ZERO COAL LEAKAGE'

Since July, 10K tonnes 'illegal coal' seized in Jharkhand & Bengal

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, September 18

The Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) has intensified its crackdown on illegal coal mining and pilferage in Jharkhand and West Bengal, recovering more than 10,000 tonnes of allegedly stolen coal and seizing vehicles during special operations since July, officials said on Friday.

The operations are being conducted under the Centre's "Zero Coal Leakage" initiative to prevent theft and pilferage of coal from mines secured by the paramilitary force in the



CISF DG Praveer Ranjan chairs a meeting

two states.

The Union government recently authorised the CISF as the designated

agency to carry out search and seizure operations under the Mines and Minerals (Development and Reg-

KEY POINTS

» Around 12,000 CISF personnel are deployed across 10 units in Jharkhand and West Bengal to protect coal mines and related installations

» CISF Director General Praveer Ranjan reviewed the security arrangements during a three-day visit to the coal belts of the two states, which concluded on Friday

ulation) Act, 1957, to check coal theft from mines under its security cover.

Around 12,000 CISF per-

sonnel are deployed across 10 units in Jharkhand and West Bengal to protect coal mines and related installations.

Meanwhile, CISF Director General Praveer Ranjan reviewed the security arrangements during a three-day visit to the coal belts of the two states, which concluded on Friday. He interacted with CISF personnel and held meetings with senior officials, police and management of coal companies.

On September 16, Ranjan visited the Eastern Coalfields Limited (ECL) Sheetalpur unit in West

Bengal, where he held discussions with the ECL management and the Asansol-Durgapur Police Commissioner on strengthening coordination to combat illegal mining and coal pilferage.

He later visited Bharat Coking Coal Limited (BCCL) in Dhanbad and interacted with more than 400 CISF personnel. He also met the BCCL CMD, Dhanbad SSP and local administration to discuss measures for achieving the zero-leakage objective.

The CISF said drone-assisted surveillance, surprise checks and other

special operations had helped recover more than 10,000 tonnes of illegal or pilfered coal since July. Several vehicles and people involved in the alleged theft were also apprehended.

The Centre has also entrusted the CISF with security of the Amrapali open-cast mine in Chatra district of Jharkhand. The force will shortly take over its security.

During his visit to IIT (ISM) Dhanbad, Ranjan discussed a proposal for an MoU to conduct short-term courses for CISF personnel on mining safety and security and cybersecurity.

ADVANCE TAX MOP-UP GREW 16.18% TO ABOUT ₹5.22 LAKH CR

Net direct tax collection rises 13% to ₹12.12 lakh crore till September 17

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 18

The government's net direct tax collection rose 13 per cent to over Rs 12.12 lakh crore till September 17 in the current financial year, buoyed by better advance tax mop-up from corporates, data released by CBDT on Friday showed.

Advance tax mop-up grew 16.18 per cent to about Rs 5.22 lakh crore. This includes an 18 per cent growth, at over Rs 4.16 lakh crore, in advance tax payments by corporates, and a 9.24 per cent rise in non-corporate advance tax of Rs 1.06 lakh crore.

Refund issuance jumped 29.19 per cent to over Rs 2.20 lakh crore till September 17, as per the CBDT data.

Gross direct tax collection clocked a 15 per cent growth, totalling over Rs 14.32 lakh crore.

After adjusting refunds, net collections from direct taxes (which includes corporate, non corporate, STT) registered a 12.96 per cent growth at over Rs 12.12 lakh crore.

Net corporate tax mop-up rose 19.48 per cent to about Rs 5.56 lakh crore, while non-corporate tax (individuals and HUFs) mop-up increased 6 per



ADVANCE TAX MOP-UP INCLUDES AN 18 PER CENT GROWTH, AT OVER RS 4.16 LAKH CRORE, IN ADVANCE TAX PAYMENTS BY CORPORATES, AND A 9.24 PER CENT RISE IN NON-CORPORATE ADVANCE TAX OF RS 1.06 LAKH CRORE

cent to over Rs 6.16 lakh crore. Securities Transactions Tax (STT) collection grew 53 per cent to Rs 40,214 crore between April 1 and September 17.

Deloitte India, Partner, Rohinton Sidhwa said the over 50 per cent increase in STT collection seems to be primarily driven by rate hikes in Budget rather than an increase in turnover. It may be recalled a 150% rate hike was made in STT rates on equity futures, effective April 1, 2026.

AKM Global, Managing Partner, Amit Maheshwari, said the tax collection

trends are broadly consistent with the underlying momentum in the domestic economy. The sustained increase in corporate and advance tax collections provides an indication of continued income and business activity during the period.

"At the same time, the 29.19% increase in refunds highlights the need to balance stronger revenue mobilisation with efficient processing of legitimate tax claims. Going forward, sustaining economic activity, broadening the tax base and strengthening technology-led compliance will

KEY POINTS

» Refund issuance jumped 29.19 per cent to over Rs 2.20 lakh crore till September 17, as per the CBDT data

» Gross direct tax collection clocked a 15 per cent growth, totalling over Rs 14.32 lakh crore

» After adjusting refunds, net collections from direct taxes posted a growth of 12.96% at over Rs 12.12 lakh crore

» Net corporate tax mop-up rose 19.48 per cent to about Rs 5.56 lakh crore, while non-corporate tax mop-up increased 6 per cent to over Rs 1.06 lakh crore

remain important for maintaining the pace of revenue growth," Maheshwari said.

EY India, Tax Partner, Jayesh Sanghvi, said the data indicates that the tax buoyancy is broad-based with non-corporate tax now accounting for 48.7 per cent of the gross pie versus corporate tax's 48.5 per cent.

"Nominal GDP for June quarter of FY27 grew 10.3 per cent, and the FY27 Budget assumes full-year nominal growth of 10 per cent. Against that baseline, gross direct tax buoyancy runs at roughly 1.47, and net buoyancy at 1.26, a meaningful

reversal from FY2025-26," Sanghvi said.

Nangia Global, Senior Partner and India Tax leader, Aravind Srivatsan, said the latest advance tax data shows underlying economics are resilient. On semi annualised basis, a 18 percent growth in corporate tax payment belies oil shocks, currency shocks and supply chain disruptions.

"Even more resilient is growth in the capital market tax collections, i.e. STT which paints the resilience of Indian stock market, trading volumes and impact of IPO activity post Covid," Srivatsan added.

Deloitte India Partner Sumeet Hemkar said the tax collection numbers suggest that the government is firmly on track towards meeting or exceeding its Budget estimates on direct tax collections for FY27.

Grant Thornton Bharat, Partner - Tax, Richa Sawhney, said direct tax collections continue to signal healthy underlying economic activity and the strength of the tax base. The steady growth in advance tax payments remains a positive indicator of taxpayer confidence, business performance and expectations of sustained income growth.

Five semiconductor plants start commercial production: Vaishnaw

NARESH BISWANI

New Delhi, September 18

From laying the foundation to building scale, India has progressed towards making a mark in the global semiconductor ecosystem as five semiconductor manufacturing plants have started commercial production, Union Electronics and IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said on Friday.

Addressing the SEMICON India 2026, Vaishnaw said the next phase of India Semiconductor Mission 2.0 will focus on building a holistic ecosystem across six areas -- design, materials and machines, fabrication plants, advanced packaging and testing units, research and development, and talent.

He said the first phase of the mission, which was originally a six-year program, was able to achieve its goals within four years.

Now the government is looking to accelerate the second phase with increasing investor interest.

Vaishnaw said the five functioning semiconductor plants were a testimony to India's capability to manufacture semiconductors competitively on the parameters of cost and quality.

He said there was a robust demand for chips, and the production capacity was being ramped up as around 40 pc of the capacity of a fab that will start operating in 2028 has



HE SAID THE FIRST PHASE OF THE MISSION, WHICH WAS ORIGINALLY A 6-YEAR PROGRAM, WAS ABLE TO ACHIEVE ITS GOALS WITHIN FOUR YEARS

already been booked.

The minister highlighted that design was India's competitive advantage, adding that about 200 chip design companies are set to emerge under ISM 2.0.

In the first phase, more than 105 start-ups have got access to advanced Electronic Design Automation tools, while 20 start-ups have received venture capital funding.

Talking about skilling, Vaishnaw said around 70,000 design engineers have been trained in four years as against a target of 85,000. Nearly 400 engineering colleges have provided access to industry-grade design tools to

students and given them an opportunity to take their taped-out design through to tape out.

In the second phase, while the focus would be on building a system design capability in addition to chip design, the government has set a target of training one lakh technicians. However, given the increasing demand, it may need to increase the target number, Vaishnaw pointed out.

India is on a trajectory towards becoming a product nation, said Vaishnaw, adding that India-designed chips find applications in strategic sectors and are being exported. India's ATMP units are already exporting to Japan and Indian chips and packages are being integrated into products destined for Switzerland, Germany, and other countries.

The minister said the convergence of electronics, semiconductor and AI manufacturing will bolster India's technology ecosystem.

SEMICON India Day 2 witnesses 25 major announcements, partnerships

NARESH BISWANI

New Delhi, September 18

The second day of SEMICON India 2026 witnessed 25 major announcements and partnerships focused on strengthening India's semiconductor ecosystem, encompassing manufacturing, materials, logistics, chip design, advanced packaging, power electronics & workforce development.

Union Electronics & IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said the event witnessed a healthy business-to-business engagement, with several deals concluded between Indian and global companies.

While the first day of the event saw around 12,000 visitors, the exhibition now has over 600 exhibitors, including around 300 international exhibitors.

Among the highlights of the day was the unveiling of India's first indigenous System-on-Module, ISC-VEGA-SOM, launched by IndieSemiC in partnership with C-DAC.

This module comprises C-DAC's VEGA Thejas32 processor and IndieSemiC's LoRa-RF module and was developed as part of C-DAC's Industry Support



Union Minister of Electronics & IT Ashwini Vaishnaw with others during the ongoing 'SEMICON India 2026' event, in New Delhi

Centre initiative. Vaishnaw said the product was a testament to the growing capabilities of Indian design houses to develop semiconductor products.

Several partnerships were announced to enhance local supply chains for materials and manufacturing.

Tata Electronics announced partnerships with INOX Air Products for high-purity gases, Sumitomo Chemical for materials, Kelington Engineering for fabrication infrastructure and Enomoto for lead-frame manufacturing.

The India Semiconductor Mission also signed an MoU with Nippon Express to bolster semiconductor logistics & supply-chain infrastructure.

In the power electronics space, L&T Semiconductor

Technologies announced partnerships for silicon-carbide power modules, renewable-energy applications, AI data centres and smart-metering solutions.

Kaynes Semicon also announced partnerships in advanced packaging, semiconductor manufacturing and energy-metering chips.

Several partnerships were announced to enhance workforce capabilities in semiconductor design and manufacturing.

NIELIT signed agreements with Siemens EDA, Tata Electronics, Singapore Polytechnic International, SCL, IESA and SEMI University for this purpose.

The event also saw the launch of an indigenous 0.8-micron open-source Process Design Kit that has been uploaded on NIELIT's eChipHub portal.

Oil India explores routes to repatriate \$300 million dividend from Russia

AGENCIES

New Delhi, September 18

State-run Oil India Ltd (OIL) is exploring options to repatriate about \$300 million in dividend income held at SBI's Moscow branch, considering routes to transfer the funds either to India or Singapore.

Speaking to reporters after the company's Annual General Meeting on Thursday, Oil India Chairman & MD Ranjit Rath said discussions are underway to

find a route for transferring the funds and stressed that the company is not concerned over the pending repatriation.

"We have about 300 million US dollar dividend in SBI branch of Moscow. So it has not yet been repatriated but we are not concerned because it is a work in progress where discussions are in underway to explore the possibility of getting the money either to Singapore or to India. Singapore is the subsidiary

investment that we have created," Rath said.

The dividend is linked to Oil India's investments in two Russian oil assets and remains in Moscow amid restrictions following Western sanctions on Russian entities and banks.

Oil India, along with Indian Oil Corporation & Bharat PetroResources Ltd, holds a 23.9 per cent participating interest in JSC Vankorneft and a 29.9 per cent stake in Tass-Yuryakh Neftegazodobycha.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



POWERGRID's Hindi book 'Akshay Urja ke Vidyut Grid Samanvayan mein HVDC Pranali ki Bhumi' was released by Ministers of State for Home Affairs Nityanand Rai and Bandi Sanjay Kumar at the 6th Akhil Bharatiya Rajbhasha Sammelan in Navi Mumbai, in the presence of Dr Yatindra Dwivedi, Director (Personnel), POWERGRID.

Mauritius Prez honours VIT Vice-President Viswanathan

MPOST BUREAU

Chennai, September 18

VIT Vice-President Sekar Viswanathan was honoured with the Ulaga Thamizhar Maamani (Crown Jewel of World Tamils) award for his contributions to higher education at the 13th Global Tamils Economic Conference and Global Economic Summit in Mauritius.

Held from September 11 to 13, the conference brought together over 200 participants, including heads of state, minis-



ters, economic experts and investors from more than 20 countries.

Mauritius President Dharambeer Gokhool

As part of its liquidity adjustment strategy, the RBI on Thursday sold government securities worth Rs 50,000 crore through Open Market Operations. Two remaining tranches of Rs 25,000 crore each are scheduled for September 21 and September 28.

Liquidity has been boosted by FCNR(B) inflows, subsequent RBI swaps and month-end government expenditure, including salaries and pensions.

presented the award to Viswanathan.

VIT Chancellor G Viswanathan attended as chief patron and special guest.

Prasanna Kumar Acharya takes charge as NLCIL Chairman & MD

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 18

Prasanna Kumar Acharya assumed charge as Chairman-cum-Managing Director (CMD) of NLC India Ltd (NLCIL) on September 17, 2026, at its corporate office in Neyveli.

Acharya, who earlier served as NLCIL's Director (Finance), has nearly three decades of experience in power, mining and infrastructure, including key roles at GRIDCO, NTPC and Tata Power.

He has contributed to



digital transformation, governance reforms, critical mineral and coal acquisitions, renewable energy projects and joint ventures. NLCIL's growth roadmap targets over 20 GW power capacity and more than 100 MTPA mining capacity by 2030.

'India seeks tech-driven advantage in mining & metals'

Dr. Jitendra Singh calls for moving towards connected, scalable and trusted systems

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 18

India must shift from resource advantage to technology-driven competitiveness in mining and metals, integrating technology across exploration, mining, processing, logistics, recycling & downstream manufacturing, Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science & Technology & Earth Sciences Dr. Jitendra Singh said on Thursday.

Addressing the 3rd FICCI conference on 'Digi-



Dr. Jitendra Singh

talization, AI, Automation & Technology Integration in Mining & Metals', he said sectoral competitiveness would depend on how efficiently, safely & sustainably India converts geological resources into high-value,

CLOSER LOOK

» He said sectoral competitiveness would depend on how efficiently, safely & sustainably India converts geological resources into high-value, resilient and circular supply chains

» 'Our ambition should be to develop, demonstrate and scale technologies in India, for India and for the world,' Singh said

resilient and circular supply chains.

He called for moving beyond isolated technology pilots towards connected, scalable and trusted systems. Digital technologies can integrate geological,

operational, equipment, process, energy, logistics and market data, enabling faster decision-making through greater visibility, prediction and automation.

Process technologies can improve extraction

and recovery, unlock low-grade ores and residues, reduce energy and water intensity, support lower-carbon metal-making and strengthen separation, refining, advanced materials and recycling.

Singh said technology companies and start-ups should develop solutions suited to Indian conditions, including varied geology, brownfield plants, environmental challenges, affordability, interoperability and scale. "Our ambition should be to develop, demonstrate

and scale technologies in India, for India and for the world," he said.

Prof Gobardhan Das, Member, NITI Aayog, said digitisation, AI & automation can boost productivity, safety, resource efficiency & sustainability, with trusted data, test beds, talent & ecosystem collaboration key to the technology transition.

FICCI and TEXMiN signed an MoU, while FICCI-KPMG released a report on India's technology-led competitiveness in mining and metals.

**CHHATTISGARH STATE RENEWABLE ENERGY DEVELOPMENT AGENCY**
(Dept. of Energy, Govt. of Chhattisgarh)
VIP Road (Airport Road), Near Energy Education Park, Raipur (C.G.)
Tel.: 94062-10918 E-mail: credatendercell@gmail.com Web: www.creda.co.in
NIT Ref. No. 8012/CREDA/MSV-B/SS-2026-27 Date: 17.09.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

CREDA invites request for proposal (RFP) for design, supply, installation and commissioning of grid-connected rooftop solar photovoltaic power plant (cumulative cap. 127kw/22nos.), solar water heating systems (250 LPD*01 nos.) with 5 years comprehensive maintenance of different capacities at Village-Kachandur District Balod of Chhattisgarh State under "Model Solar Village" component of PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana.

Last date of submission of Online Bid : 08.10.2026 till 5:00 PM
Opening of Technical Bid : 12.10.2026 11:00 AM onwards

Technical Bid and Price Bid shall be submitted online only at <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in>. However Technical Bid (as per the checklist) also has to be submitted duly signed hard copy at Chief Engineer (Tender Cell). If there is any discrepancy in the e-Bid and hard copy, only the documents in e-Bid shall be valid. In no case the hard copy of documents shall be evaluated, they are only for record keeping by CREDA. Bidders are advised to follow the instructions provided for Registration and e-Submission Process accordingly. (For any query about e-bidding please visit user manual at <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in>).

Tender document with all terms and conditions is available at www.creda.co.in and at <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in>.

CREDA reserves all rights to accept/reject any or all tenders in full/part without assigning any reasons.

samvad 49095/3

Chief Engineer
CREDA

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSONS

See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused persons (1) **Rahul S/o Sahib Rao, R/o F-251, Sahyog Vihar, Matiyala, Uttam Nagar, West Delhi-59**, (2) **Touseeb S/o Ayyub R/o H. No. C-155, Gali No. 12, Krishna Nagar, East Delhi-51**, (3) **Surojit Kumar Gupta S/o Sudhir Gupta R/o 73B, Alipore Road, Alipore, H.O. Kolkata, West Bengal-700027**, (4) **Samrat Nandy S/o Keshab Nandy, R/o 34/3, New Chord Road, Near Exide Quarter Gate, Athpur, North 24, Parganas, West Bengal, have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 270/2024 Dt.: 17.05.2024, U/S 406/420/120B IPC, PS Anand Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused persons cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused persons have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that (1) **Rahul** (2) **Touseeb** (3) **Surojit Kumar Gupta** (4) **Samrat Nandy** the said accused of **FIR No. 270/2024 Dt.: 17.05.2024, U/S 406/420/120B IPC, PS Anand Vihar, Delhi**, are required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.11.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Manish Jain
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate,
Court No.-62, 3rd Floor, Shahdara Distt.,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/13142/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Imran, S/o: Habib Ahmad, R/o: A-422, Gali No. 05, Eidgah Road, Janta Colony, Welcome, Shastri Park, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 394/2020, U/s: 392/394/411/34 IPC, Police Station Shastri Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Imran** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Imran** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Imran of Police Station Shastri Park, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.01.2027**.

By Order
Ms. Norma Jain
Ld. JMFC-03, North-East,
1st Floor, Room No. 22,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/13246/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.PC./84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sonu Kumar, S/o Suraj Pal, R/o 1) H-3/216, 217, Sultanpuri, Delhi, 2) Village Kalai, P.S. Harduba Ganj, District Aligarh, UP** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 940/2017, U/s 363/365 IPC, P.S. Aman Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sonu Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sonu Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sonu Kumar** accused of **FIR No. 940/2017, U/s 363/365 IPC, P.S. Aman Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.10.2026**.

By Order - Ms. Shagun
Judicial Magistrate First Class, North-West
DP/13176/RD/2026 Room No. 109, Rohini Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Virender Kamti S/o Mohan Kamti R/o B-343, JJ Colony, Suraj Park, Badli, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 238/2019, U/S 279/338 IPC, PS Sarai Rohilla, North Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Virender Kamti** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Virender Kamti** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Virender Kamti** the said accused of **FIR No. 238/2019, U/S 279/338 IPC, PS Sarai Rohilla, North Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Ankit Solanki
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04,
Central Distt., Court No.-37,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/13174/N/2026
(Court Matter)

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-Tender No. - PRYJ-Sig-037-2026-27

Date : 16.09.2026

E-Tender Notice

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer / Coordination / North Central Railway/ Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite E-TENDER on prescribed form for the following works up to 12.00 hrs. on the opening date of E-tender mentioned therein. The details of the Tender are as under:-

Tender No.: 037, **Name of work:** (A) S&T Works in connection with Prayagraj - Kanpur TSR(P) - 38.942 Tkm. (B) S&T Works in connection with Prayagraj - Kanpur-CTR(S) 17.661 Tkm. (C) S&T Works for Prayagraj - Pt Deen Dayal Upadhyaya - Prayagraj TSR (P) 15.064 Tkm (D) S&T Works for Prayagraj - Prayagraj Kanpur - TRR(P) - 9.006 Tkm. (E) S&T Works for Prayagraj - Pt Deen Dayal Upadhyaya - Prayagraj TRR(P) - 1.494 Tkm. (F) S&T Works for TTR (TWS) 45 sets in CAR CPU section in connection with 'CAR-CPU, SKB-FBD, BRN-ETH, CNB-CPA & ETW-MNQ' - TTR (TWS) - 86sets.

Approx Cost of work : ₹ 1,57,00,275.76

Bid Security : ₹ 3,14,00,00.00

Cost of Tender Form: ₹ 0.00

Completion Period : 12 Months

Date of Opening of tender: 13.10.2026

Validity of offer : 60 days from the date of opening

Availability of tender form: Tender forms are available on www.ireps.gov.in

Bid Security to be deposited: The prescribed amount of Bid Security as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form Online through Internet Banking or Online Payment gateway only. The tenderer(s) should note that, in any case, the Bid Security in any other form than specified in GCC shall be acceptable. If the Bid Security deposited by the bidder is in shape of Bank Guarantee, it should be supported by proper stamp duty, rate prescribed as per section 13 & 24 of the UP Stamp Act, 2008 and amended from time to time at the time of submission of Bank Guarantee. Tenders without Bid Security shall be summarily rejected.

Time & place of opening of tender: Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj at or after 12.30 hours. In case tender opening date happens to be holiday, Tenders will be opened on the next working day.

Right of Railway to deal with tender: Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. 2125/26 (MG)

 North central railways

 @CPRONCR

 www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

**NORTHERN RAILWAY**

TENDER NOTICE FOR CORRIGENDUM

Invitation of Tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

Sr.DMM, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the president of India invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items.

Sr. No.	Tender No., Brief Description	Qty.	Closing date
1.	93256125 EOT Crane 25/5 Ton	2 Nos.	12-10-2026

Note: -1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No Manual offer will be entertained.

Sr.DMM/NS/LP/93256125/2026 Date: - 18.09.2026

3238/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

**NORTHERN RAILWAY**

Tender Notice

Invitation of Tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

N.I.T. No. 18 (A,B,C)/26-27/WE

Name of work with its location	
(A) Repair of damaged sewer line, storm water drain, water supply system in block no.30,31,32 and 37 to 40 & repair of CHI Office, staff tool room at PB railway colony and Repair of damaged Bituminous road surface, Sewer line and restoration of road side footpaths, strengthening of colony boundary wall & fencing work in Punjabi Bagh, Dayabasti and RPF line to enhance safety, security and structural stability and Urgent repair to damaged workshop shed sheeting, valley gutters rainwater pipes and corroded steel members at EWS (Electric work shop) DBSI in the section of S/O SSE/W/PB under ADENE-IV.	
(B) Heavy repair to outside plaster, sunshade, balcony, parapet wall, leaky Roof, approach Road, sewer system, replacement of Broken doors, windows, SCI stacks and providing safety doors, Improvement of kitchen, bath, lavatory, Room tiles, sanitary fittings and development of common area in Block 1 to 6, 11 to 12 at Wazirpur staff qtrs. in the section of SSE/W/Punjabi Bagh under ADENE-II and Repair to apron of blocks and parks, repair to toilet, urgent misc. repair to quarter, and repair to unpopular/newly allotted qtrs. at DKZ-II Railway Colony in the S/o of SSE/W/DKZ-II under ADENE-IV.	
(C) Merging of 32 nos. Type-I qtrs. into 16 nos. Type-II qtrs. of block no. 14 & 15 at Punjabi Bagh railway colony in the S/o of SSE/W/PB and Merging of two type-I qtrs. into one type-II qtrs. of block no. 107 & 108 at DKZ-II Railway Colony in the S/o of SSE/W/DKZ-II under ADENE-IV.	

Approx. cost of work (A) 3,09,99,564.68 (B) 1,19,99,948.59 (C) 14967587.69

EMD amount (A) 6,20,000.00 (B) 2,40,000.00 (C) 2,99,400.00

Completion period of work (A) 10 Months (B) 08 Months (C) 08 Months

Date and Time for submission of tender and opening of tender

Closing date of tender on 14.10.2026 at 15:00 hrs.

Website particular notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc.

Above tender available on website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in>

No:128-W/269/O.C./T/NIT No.18(A,B,C)/26-27/WE/ Dated:-17.09.2026 3232/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

**PUBLIC NOTICE**

Sunder Singh, son of Mr. Khushal Singh, resident of 586-A, New UNV Public School, Faridkot Colony, Sector 22, Faridkot, Haryana, state that Shubham Rawal is my biological son and Ananddeep Kaur, wife of Shubham Rawal, is my daughter-in-law. And Anany, daughter of Shubham Rawal, is my Grand-daughter, who is beyond the control of me or my family, and always acts according to his own will. He does not obey me or any member of my family and frequently fights and fights with one and my family. That I and my family are deeply troubled by this behavior of the above, and despite being counselled by relatives, he does not desist from making mistakes. Therefore, I disclaim my above-mentioned son/daughter-in-law, and grand-daughter from all my movable and immovable property, from today onwards, neither I nor any member of my family will have any kind of connection with him. If any person claims to have any claim on my above mentioned property, feedback, if anyone has any kind of relationship, dealings, court cases, transactions with my above mentioned son, daughter-in-law and grand-daughter, fights or fights with one, or causes any financial incident to happen to them, then they themselves will be responsible for it. Neither I nor any member of my family will have any responsibility of any kind.

Applicant - Shri Sunder Singh

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
(UNDER GUARDIAN AND WARD ACT)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Sohan Lal Malik
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), Bhiwani
SANTOSHI DEVI
Vs.
GENERAL PUBLIC
CNR No.HRBH02-002020-2026
Next Date 02-11-2026

NOTICE TO:
General Public
:-
ALL INDIA,
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 02-11-2026 at 10:00 am. For details login to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=distict notice & district = Bhiwani>
Sd/- Sh. Sohan Lal Malik
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division) Bhiwani
Dated 15.09-2026

**EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY**

CORRIGENDUM NOTICE

Tender Notice No. ECR-NCA-OT-03-26-27 Dated 12.09.2026

Corrigendum No. ECR-NCA-OT-03-26-27 Dated 17.09.2026

For and on behalf of President of India, Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/MEMU, Jhajha, East Central Railway, Danapur issued a corrigendum on date 17.09.2026 for Tender Notice No. ECR-NCA-OT-03-26-27 Dated 12.09.2026.

Name of Work : Outsourcing of non-core activities at MEMU car shed, JHAJHA for a period of two years."

S.N. : 1. Weightage : 20%. Technical criteria: Previous work done: The bidder shall submit documents related to Completed/ on-going similar service contracts during the last three previous financial years and the current financial year along with the details payments received and percentage penalties imposed therein to classify the completed/on-going similar service contracts in the following categories. Payment received more than or equal to 80% or 50% or 40% or the current advertised value and percentage penalties I m p o s e d therein.. **Documentation:** Certificate from client firm authorizing payment received along with percentage penalties imposed, contract-wise for completed/ on-going similar service contracts with satisfactory performance..

Scoring: Scoring method: For each completed/ on-going similar service contracts with satisfactory performance shall be as under: (a) 100 marks if the bidder has completed or received payment as under: 1 project>80% 2 projects>50% or 3 Or more projects >40% of the advertised value of the bid. (b) 50 marks if the bidder has completed or received payment as under: 1 project>50% or 2 Projects>40% of the advertised value of the bid. (c) 20 marks if the bidder has completed or received payment as under: 1 project> 40% value completed (d) No marks if all projects> 40% value completed. **Reduction for percentage penalty imposed in the respective completed on-going similar service contracts:** the score of each completed/ on-going similar service contracts with satisfactory performance shall be reduced by a percentage equal to the percentage penalty imposed in respective contract. No reduction for percentage penalty less than 5%. Contract where percentage penalty is more than 20% of contract value shall not be considered for calculation of scores for this purpose. **S.N. : 2. Weightage : 35%. Technical criteria:** Turnover (in last three and current financial year) (Less than 1.5 times the value of work is not eligible).. **Documentation:** As per standard balance sheet certified by the CA. **Scoring:** (a) 100 marks- more than 25 times advertised value of work. (b)75 Marks- 10-25 times advertised value of work. (c) 50 marks- 5-10 times advertised value of work. (d)30 marks- 1-5 times advertised value of work. **S.N. : 3. Weightage : 20%. Technical criteria:** Number of years in operations (Firms having less than 1-year of experience are not eligible). **Documentation:** Company establishment certificate and company's work order copy/agreement copy/completion certificate etc. as proof of operation. Years shall be counted from the date of agreement of the work.. **Scoring:** (a) 100 marks- more than 8 years (b) 80 marks- 5- 8 years (c) 60 marks- 2-5 years (d) 40 marks- 1-2 years. **4. Weightage : 25%. Technical criteria:** Size of Workforce The Bidder must have a minimum number of personnel (as defined by Railway administration) on the organization's pay roll. **Documentation:** EPFO challan/bank account statement in support available manpower of (duly submitted to EPFO) in respect of the previous four quarters preceding the date of opening of Bid should be submitted in support of their qualification. **Scoring:** a) 100 Marks if the Bidder's workforce on roll is greater than 3 times of the total workforce required in this Bid. b) 70 marks if workforce on roll is equal to or up to 3 times the total workforce required in this Bid. c) No marks if workforce on roll deployed is less than the total workforce required in this Bid. **Example: A bidder secured marks against Srl. No. 1 = W, Srl. No.2 = X, Srl. No.3 = Y, Srl. No.4 = Z then, Total Marks scored (T) with minimum 1 year experience = 0.2 W + 0.35 X + 0.2 Y + 0.25 Z, T ≥ 20 to qualify. Note:** Firms having less than 1-year experience are not eligible.

Sr. DEE/MEMU/JAJHA
MEMU Car Shed Jhajha
East Central Railway, Danapur
PR/0943/MCS/JAJ/ELECT/C/26-27/120

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Sohan Lal Malik
Rent Controller, Bhiwani
NISHA
Vs.
CHET RAM
CNR No.HRBH02-000623-2021
Next Date 31-10-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
A. MEENAKSHI D/O DEVILAL @ BITTU S/O CHET RAM
5. TARA D/O CHET RAM AND W/O RAJENDER
BOTH R/O VPO SATROD KHURD, DISTT. HISAR
6. MITRA D/O CHET RAM AND WIFE OF DIWAN CHAND R/O JAITA MANDI, DISTRICT BHATINDA (PUNJAB)
7. SUKANT D/O CHET RAM AND NOW WIFE OF SURAJBHAN R/O SIRSA
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 31-10-2026 at 10:00 am. For details login to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=distict notice & district = Bhiwani>
Sd/- Sh. Sohan Lal Malik
Rent Controller Bhiwani
Dated 16.09-2026

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF Ms. Taranjit Kaur
Principal Judge Family Court, CHARKHI DADRI
Kamlesh
Vs.
General Public
Case No. : GW/60/2025
CNR No. HRCDD1-005015-2025
Next Date:-07-12-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
General Public
Charkhi Dadri
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 07-12-2026 at 10:00 am. For details login to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=distict notice & district = CHARKHI DADRI>
Sd/-Ms. Taranjit Kaur
Principal Judge Family Court
Dated 14.09.2026 Charkhi Dadri

**UJVN LIMITED**
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, C.M.S. Road, Dharadun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvn.com

Tender Notice

Letter No: 824 Date: 18/09/2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil-I), UJVN Limited, Srikot- Srinagar, Garhwal, invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Summary of tender is given below:

1. **TenderNo-05/EE(Civil-I)/Sriko/Dunao/2026-27** for the work "Protection civil work of Desilting Tank at Ram Prasad Nautiyal (Dunao) SHP (2x750kw), in Distt Pauri Garhwal"
Estimated cost: Rs 20.08 Lakh (Plus GST Extra)

2. **TenderNo-06/EE(Civil-I)/Sriko/KG-II/2026-27** for the work "Civil Protection and Drainage Management Works at TRC/Waterfall and River Embankment Zone at Kaliganga-II (2x2.25 MW) SHP inDistt- Rudraprayag".
Estimated cost: Rs 20.25 Lakh (Plus GST Extra)

Date of availability of bid document on website : 19.09.2026 at 17:00 Hrs. **Last date for submission of tender :** 15.10.2026 at 14:30 Hrs
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvn.com"
Executive Engineer (Civil-I)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

**ICICI Bank**

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Tarun Kumar Tripathi / Anbta Tripathi / LBDEL00000661446	Plot No. C-164, Sector-3, Kashmeri Enclave (Loni Housing), Tronica City, Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh- 200001/ September 16, 2026	April 16, 2026 Rs. 5,44,740.00/-	Delhi/ NCR
2.	Pammi Tejraana- Deceased (Through Her Legal Heir/ Rahul Dev/ LBDEL00001491797	Dda Mig Flat No. 267- A, Ground Floor, Pocket- C, Mayur Vihar Phase-2, New Delhi 110091/ September 16, 2026	January 28, 2026 Rs. 54,80,102.87/-	Delhi/ NCR

The above-mentioned borrower(s)/guarantor(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: September 19, 2026
Place: Delhi/ Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

**New Okhla Industrial Development Authority**
Administrative Building, Sector-6, Noida G.B Nagar, (U.P.)
Website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tenders are invited from firms / contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened / downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in & <https://etender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes / amendments & corrigendum etc.

1. Job No. - 04/COMPUTERCELL/COM. ACCESS.(II)/26-27, Procurement of Computer Accessories of Rs. 29,53,895/-

The above tenders can be uploaded by date **01.10.2026** upto **5.00 PM**. Pre-qualification shall be opened / downloaded on date **05.10.2026 at 11.00 AM**.

प्रबन्धक (कम्प्यूटर सैल)

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Karan Preet Singh, S/o. Nanak Singh, R/o: H.No. B-25 Asha Park, Gali No. 3, Hari Nagar, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 361/2021, U/s: 356/379/411 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Tilak Nagar, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Karanpreet Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Karan Preet Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Karan Preet Singh, FIR No.: 361/2021, U/s: 356/379/411 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Tilak Nagar, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh Vikas Madaan
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/13131/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-TENDER NOTICE

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Coordination/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite E-TENDER on prescribed form for the following works up to 12.00 hrs. on the opening date of E-tender mentioned therein. The details of the Tender are as under:-

Tender No.: 039

Approx. Cost of Work : ₹ 94001083.60

Name of Work: (A) S&T works in c/w Provision of Yard remodeling work in PRYJ end & HWH end at Chunar Jn. and (B) Provision of 02 rake handling capacity at a time in Chunar goods shed.

Earnest Money : ₹ 1880000.00

Cost of Tender form: ₹ 0.00

Completion Period : 12 Months

Date of Opening of Tender : 13.10.2026

Availability of tender form: Tender forms are available on www.ireps.gov.in. **Earnest Money to be deposited:** The prescribed amount of Bid Security as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form Online through Internet Banking or Online Payment gateway only. The tenderer(s) should note that, in any case, the Bid Security in any other form than specified in GCC shall be acceptable. If the Bid Security deposited by the bidder is in shape of Bank Guarantee, it should be supported by proper stamp duty, rate prescribed as per section 13 & 24 of the UP Stamp Act, 2008 and amended from time to time at the time of submission of Bank Guarantee. Tenders without Bid Security shall be summarily rejected. **Time & Place of opening of Tender:** Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj at or after 12.30 hours. In case tender opening date happens to be holiday, Tenders will be opened on the next working day. **Validity of offer:** 60 days from the date of opening. **Right of Railway to deal with Tender:** Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. 2124/26 (A)

 North central railways

 @CPRONCR

 www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-TENDER NOTICE

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Coordination/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite E-TENDER on prescribed form for the following works up to 12.00 hrs. on the opening date of E-tender mentioned therein. The details of the work are as under:-

Tender No.: 171

Approx. Cost of work (Rs.): 8,49,10,980.00

Name of Work : Supply, Stacking and Spreading of 29000 cum Machine Crushed, Hard Granite Stone Ballast of 65 mm Gauge in various yards and locations between Prayagraj-Kanpur section under the jurisdiction of Sr. Divisional Engineer/II/Prayagraj.

Earnest Money (Rs.): 16,98,200.00

Completion Period : 12 (Twelve) Months

Date of Opening of tender : 14.10.2026

Minimum Eligibility Criteria for "Similar work" : Supply of machine crushed stone ballast/machine crushed coarse stone aggregate.

Note-1: Tenderers have to submit following test report along with their tender document from any reputed Govt. organization/Institutions, as per the list given in the tender document, otherwise their tender will not be considered. (i) Size Gradation Test, (ii) Abrasion Value Test, (iii) Impact Value Test, (iv) Water Absorption Test. **Note-2:** 1: E-Tender Forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderers. 2: The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website www.ireps.gov.in, up to 13:30 hrs. on the due date of tender opening i.e. 14.10.2026. 3: Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. 4: Rates entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall be considered. Rates and any other financial entry in any other form/letter head if attached by vendors shall be straightaway ignored and shall not be considered. 5: The tenderers shall submit a certificate as given in tender document as "Annexure" in standard format without which their tender may not be considered and shall be summarily rejected. 6: The supplier / contractor of goods and / or services would be subject to GST Act and Rules as applicable from time to time. 7: Document being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. 8: This tender notice has also been uploaded on www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in. 9: Payment of Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) in respect of e-tendering shall be accepted through net banking or payment gateway only. 10: In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 11: Tender on line can be submitted up to 13:30 hrs. of tender opening date i.e. 14.10.2026. 12: The tenderer has to submit necessary documents in compliance of clause 10 to 18 (Part-I) of GCC-2022 mandatorily, otherwise offer will be considered as Incomplete Offer and accordingly shall not be considered. 2127/26 (AS)

 North central railways

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**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Tender Notice No.:

AS DEMAND IS EXPECTED TO PICK UP IN FESTIVE SEASON

Centre relaxes sugar stockholding limit for bulk consumers to 30 days

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 18

The government on Friday said it has relaxed the stockholding limit for bulk sugar consumers to 30 days from the existing 15 days, as the festive season approaches and demand is expected to pick up.

Currently, bulk consumers who use more than 10 tonnes of sugar a month as a raw material – for production, consumption or other industrial use – are allowed to hold stock for up to 15 days of their requirement.

This limit will now be doubled, the Department of Food and Public Distribution said in a statement, but with a caveat: any stock held beyond the earlier 15-day cap must come exclusively from sugar imported under the Tariff Rate Quota (TRQ) or the Advance Authorisation Scheme (AAS).

The government has already permitted import of 10 lakh tonnes under TRQ, besides allowing domestic sale of export-



bound sugar procured under the AAS.

Stock sourced from the open market will continue to be capped at 15 days' consumption, the ministry clarified. To keep track of inventories, the government has also introduced a mechanism requiring bulk consumers to declare and disclose their sugar stocks every Friday through the food ministry's online portal, foodstock.dfpd.gov.in.

The ministry said the decision followed detailed consultations with major bulk consumers, who had sought an enhanced stockholding limit ahead of the festival season.

They had also proposed

being allowed to source sugar directly from importers holding TRQ and AAS stock, to ensure uninterrupted supply for industrial use without straining domestic availability. The government said the step was meant to balance the interests of bulk consumers with the need for stability in the domestic sugar market, offering industrial users more flexibility during the festive months while ensuring additional stock comes from imports rather than adding pressure on local supplies.

Separately, the Centre flagged that while ex-mill sugar prices have fallen by nearly 25 per cent, retail

KEY POINTS

» 'The decision followed detailed consultations with major bulk consumers, who had sought an enhanced stockholding limit'

» They had also proposed being allowed to source sugar directly from importers holding TRQ and AAS stock

prices have declined by only about 10 per cent from their August peak of Rs 65 to Rs 58.50 currently -- indicating that the benefit of cheaper wholesale rates has not fully reached consumers.

At a joint meeting with representatives of the Indian Sugar and Bio-energy Manufacturers Association (ISMA), the National Federation of Cooperative Sugar Factories, and sugar trade bodies, the Secretary of the Department of Food and Public Distribution said the correction at the mill level had not been adequately passed on downstream.

The government urged

wholesalers, retailers and the wider trade to immediately transmit the benefit of lower ex-mill prices to consumers, calling on the sugar value chain to keep sugar and sugar-based products affordable through the festive season.

The Secretary said farmers and consumers remained the two pillars of India's sugar policy, and that the government had worked to balance remunerative returns for sugarcane growers with reasonable prices for consumers.

From October 1, 2026, with the start of the new sugar season, farmers will receive a higher Fair and Remunerative Price (FRP) of Rs 365 per quintal – part of the government's practice of raising the FRP annually.

The ministry said it would continue to monitor sugar availability and prices closely and take further measures as needed to ensure adequate supply for both consumers and industries such as food processing.

Markets close on mixed note amid selling in IT and Tata group shares

Reversing its early gains, the rupee closed lower by 7 paise at 95.96 against the US dollar on Friday

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, September 18

Benchmark stock indices Sensex and Nifty ended mixed on Friday as a drop in crude oil prices was overshadowed by weakness in IT stocks and Tata Group counters.

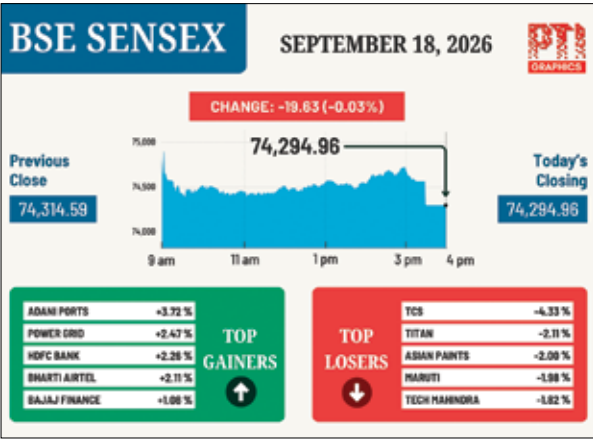
Giving up intraday gains during the Closing Auction Session (CAS), the 30-share BSE Sensex dropped 19.63 points, or 0.03 per cent, to settle at 74,294.96. During the day, it surged 413.85 points, or 0.55 per cent, to 74,728.44.

The 50-share NSE Nifty closed higher by 75.80 points, or 0.33 per cent, at 23,346.40, marking its third straight session of gains.

Among the 30 Sensex firms, Tata Consultancy Services tanked 4.33 per cent, Titan 2.11 per cent, Asian Paints 2 per cent, Maruti 1.98 per cent, Tech Mahindra 1.82 per cent and Tata Steel 1.73 per cent.

Adani Ports, Power Grid, HDFC Bank and Bharti Airtel were among the major winners.

Broader markets, however, advanced with the



BSE SmallCap Select index jumping by 1.56 per cent and MidCap Select index climbing 0.79 per cent.

Among the BSE sectoral indices, Focused IT declined 1.44 per cent, IT 1.34 per cent, Consumer Durables 1.27 per cent and FMCG 0.52 per cent. Services climbed 1.73 per cent, Industrials jumped 1.70 per cent, Capital Goods 1.56 per cent, Housing Finance 1.48 per cent, Power 1.32 per cent, Utilities 1.15 per cent and Oil & Gas 0.91 per cent.

On the weekly front, the BSE benchmark dropped 486.8 points, or 0.65 per cent, and the Nifty dipped

51.7 points, or 0.22 per cent.

Reversing its early gains, the rupee closed lower by 7 paise at 95.96 against the US dollar on Friday amid a strong American currency and high crude oil prices.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, declined 1.35 per cent to \$103.4 per barrel.

FIIs offloaded equities worth Rs 3,208.76 crore on Thursday, according to exchange data.

On Thursday, the Sensex dipped 21.86 points, or 0.03 per cent, to settle at 74,314.59. The Nifty ended marginally up 53 points, or 0.23 per cent, at 23,270.60.

NSE IPO fully subscribed on day 2, led by NIIs, QIBs

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 18

The Rs 22,569-crore initial public offering of the National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) was fully subscribed on the second day of bidding on Friday, driven by strong response from non-institutional investors (NIIs) & qualified institutional buyers (QIBs).

The IPO received bids for 10,28,43,656 shares against 8,86,42,911 shares on offer, translating into 1.16 times subscription, according to BSE data.

The NII portion was subscribed 1.68 times, while the QIB category received 1.53 times subscription. The retail investors quota was subscribed 72 per cent.

The offering is India's second-largest public issue after Hyundai Motor India's Rs 27,870-crore IPO in 2024, surpassing LIC's Rs



21,000-crore issue in 2022.

The NSE raised Rs 6,746 crore from anchor investors on Wednesday, with participants including LIC, Goldman Sachs, Fidelity, GIC Singapore, ADIA and Norges Bank.

The IPO comprises an Offer For Sale (OFS) of up to 12.64 crore equity shares by existing shareholders. The price band is Rs 1,700-1,785 per share, valuing NSE at up to Rs 4.42 lakh crore.

The issue closes on September 21, with shares expected to list on September 24. Since it is entirely an OFS, proceeds will go to existing shareholders.

Warren Buffett steps down as Berkshire chief

The company named Buffett's son, Howard Buffett as chairman

AGENCIES
Washington, September 18

Berkshire Hathaway said on Friday that Warren Buffett will step down as chairman and become chairman emeritus with immediate effect, nine months after handing over the CEO role to longtime lieutenant Greg Abel.

The company named Buffett's son, Howard Buffett, a director since 1993, as chairman. Unlike his father, Howard Buffett, known as Howie, will not have a management role and will primarily be responsible for preserving Berkshire's culture.

Buffett, 96, joined Berkshire in 1965 and transformed it from a struggling textile company into a \$1.1 trillion conglomerate, while his investment philosophy shaped generations of investors and corporate leaders. "Father Time always wins. He has, however, been generous with me," Buffett wrote in a letter to shareholders on Friday.



Warren Buffett

"As Chairman Emeritus, Mr. Buffett will remain a member of the Board of Directors and will continue to offer his valued judgment and perspective," Berkshire said. Abel said the culture and values built by Buffett would remain central to Berkshire, with Howard

HOWARD BUFFETT WILL NOT HAVE A MANAGEMENT ROLE AND WILL PRIMARILY BE RESPONSIBLE FOR PRESERVING BERKSHIRE'S CULTURE

serving as their guardian.

Berkshire's Class B shares were down 0.3 per cent in premarket trading. The conglomerate's price-to-book value has declined from around 1.62 to 1.53 since Buffett announced his plan to step down as CEO, according to LSEG data. Buffett announced his succession plans in May 2025, making the transition one of the most closely watched in corporate America. Investors have long attributed a "Buffett premium" to Berkshire shares.

to Berkshire shares.

Berkshire remains the only financial company among firms with a market value above \$1 trillion. Its businesses include Geico, BNSF Railway, energy and industrial companies and Dairy Queen, while it also holds hundreds of billions of dollars in stocks and US Treasuries. In the second quarter, Berkshire's operating profit rose 16 per cent to \$12.98 billion, beating analyst forecasts, while net income more than doubled to \$25.67 billion.

The company's culture emphasises decentralised management, disciplined capital allocation, simplicity and long-term thinking. Howard Buffett described it as keeping things simple, treating people fairly, respecting managers and shareholders, and being honest about bad news.

Building AI for Scale in a Diverse Country: Inside PhonePe's AI Bet

According to the data from NPCI, UPI recorded a massive 24.51 billion transactions in August alone

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 18

India's payments story is one for the books. Led by UPI, the country has built an open-banking infrastructure that is now inspiring nations across the Middle East, Southeast Asia, and Europe to develop similar real-time systems.

Considering the scale of this ecosystem and observing how market leaders deploy next-generation technology, provides insights into the future of digital retail - more specifically in the fintech space.

According to data from NPCI, UPI recorded a massive 24.51 billion transactions in August alone. PhonePe maintained its market leadership by processing 11.19 billion of those transactions, accounting for 45.64% of the total ecosystem volume. A platform serving a base of over 72 crore users and 5 crore merchants, certainly deploys robust AI solutions to drive deeper value and scale personalization.

Let's take a deeper look

at how AI is reshaping payments in India, made possible by the nation's current largest payments player.

Beyond Hype: What PhonePe's AI Charter Is Trying to Solve

Rahul Chari, Founder & CPTO of PhonePe captures the essence of the company's approach to AI with a simple premise: not every interaction needs AI. Indians across geographies and demographics are already comfortable with peer-to-peer transfers, QR-based payments, recharges, and bill payments. They don't need a conversational agent in the middle.

AI is a layer that can be added where it meaningfully improves access, understanding, or decision-making. While this translates to subtle enhancements to existing flows in certain instances, it may lead to reimagining an experience entirely in others.

Two themes stand out in PhonePe's AI charter:

1. Breaking language and access barriers
2. Handholding users through complex



financial decisions

Breaking the Language and Access Barrier

India's Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) offers platforms like PhonePe an abundance of structured data. However, a lot of information that could unlock services like credit rests on unstructured data.

Chari points to a structural gap: today, credit bureau coverage is only around 50-60%. This indicates that a significant number of people who are creditworthy are "invisible" to traditional underwriting.

AI, in this context, is less about chatbots and more about making sense of disorganised or "unstructured", real-world facts.

Chari gives a concrete example from merchant lending:

CLOSER LOOK

» In a nation with vast linguistic and cultural diversity, the true metric of success for payments isn't just speed, but accessibility

» PhonePe's AI journey is a microcosm of a larger shift in fintech: from building rails to building relationships, from moving money to making sense of it

"When we are trying to say, disburse a loan, or approve a merchant for a loan - if we are able to take images of the store, to then determine the age of the store, the upkeep, the stocking, the kind of items that are there, and add that to the existing data on payments flow, etc. available in real time - it can enable perhaps a larger loan or a loan on better terms."

This is a highly practical solution based on computer vision, pattern recognition, and real-time decisioning. It offers merchants who don't have a formal credit footprint but have a business, inventory, and a payment trail, an opportunity to leverage the power of credit.

Language, Voice, and Vernacular Interfaces

In a nation with vast linguistic and cultural diversity, the true metric of success for payments isn't just speed, but accessibility. Breaking down the language barrier is a massive differentiator AI is set to bring to the space.

According to Chari, this translates to:

- Large language models that understand and respond in vernacular languages
- Voice-based interfaces that allow users to speak naturally rather than navigate menus
- Interactive flows that can collect information and provide guidance in real time

In practice, this could mean a user in a Tier-3 town using conversational AI on the PhonePe app to,

say, understand loan eligibility, or a user asking, in their native language, how to pay an electricity bill or discover a service.

Handholding Through Complex Financial Decisions

Complex financial journeys such as investing, buying insurance, planning a holiday, or even understanding spending patterns are seen as fairly more complex journeys.

PhonePe's AI charter leans heavily into this gap.

1. **From Search to Guided Action:** One of the simpler but powerful use cases Chari outlines is AI-enhanced search within the PhonePe app. Instead of hunting through menus, a user could simply ask, "Mujhe sona kha-reedna hain" - translating to "I want to buy gold". The system then returns to the exact action page, pre-fills known information, and simplifies the journey to almost a one-click experience. This is where natural language processing, semantic understanding, and context come together.
2. **Conversational**

Transaction Insights: PhonePe is also looking at leveraging AI to turn raw transaction data into conversational insights at a per-user level. Questions like "Year over year, how have my spends trended?" or "Where can I potentially save money?" would allow users to discuss their finances with the app and eventually guide them toward relevant products like mutual funds, gold, or other instruments based on those insights.

While the business incentive of cross-selling and higher product adoption is apparent, financial literacy and planning is interactive and moreover, personalised.

Imagine a conversational holiday planning interface within the PhonePe app that could help with research and then seamlessly transition into bookings. That's a step change from the general practice,

where users research on one platform and book on another.

With insurance, an AI layer can help users research and compare policies, discuss personal context (like family health history), then move into an "agentic" mode to complete the purchase and get the policy.

The Bigger Picture: AI as the Second Layer of India's Payments Story

To sum up, the contours for how money runs on top of India's DPI are clear:

- Use AI to break language and access barriers in a country of many tongues and uneven literacy.
 - Combine structured DPI data with unstructured signals to underwrite those the formal system has missed.
 - Turn apps from static menus into conversational guides for complex financial decisions.
- PhonePe's AI journey is a microcosm of a larger shift in fintech: from building rails to building relationships, from moving money to making sense of it.

158 CONTINGENT MEMBERS TO TAKE PART
 Bhaker, Toor named India's flag-bearers for Asiad opening

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
 Nagoya, September 18

Double Olympic medal-winning shooter Manu Bhaker and defending shot put champion Tajinderpal Singh Toor were on Friday named as India's flag-bearers for Asian Games opening ceremony here.

The ceremony is scheduled for Saturday, and a 158-strong Indian contingent will take part in it.

"Manu Bhaker will be one of the flag-bearers," India's chef-de-Mission Sahdev Yadav said. Later, the Athletics Federation of India confirmed that Toor will be the second flag-bearer.

One of the four deputy chefs de mission and decorated former shooter, Anjali Bhagwat, said 158 members of the Indian contingent will take part in the opening ceremony.

Bhaker made history at the 2024 Paris Olympics by becoming the first athlete from Independent India to win two medals in a single edition of the Olympic Games. Toor has finished with gold medals in the past two editions of the Asian Games.

The selection of Bhaker and Toor as flag bearers was on expected lines as shooting and athletics contribute a major share of the total number medals for the country in the Asian Games. In the last Asian Games in Hangzhou, China, in

20th Asian Games: Aichi-Nagoya 2026

India's Performance at the Asian Games

Edition	Year	City, Country	Gold	Silver	Bronze	Total	Rank
1	1951	New Delhi, India	15	16	20	51	2
2	1954	Manila, Philippines	4	4	5	13	4
3	1958	Tokyo, Japan	5	3	3	11	6
4	1962	Jakarta, Indonesia	10	13	11	34	3
5	1966	Bangkok, Thailand	7	4	11	22	5
6	1970	Bangkok, Thailand	6	9	10	25	5
7	1974	Tehran, Iran	4	12	12	28	7
8	1978	Bangkok, Thailand	11	11	6	28	6
9	1982	New Delhi, India	13	19	25	57	5
10	1986	Seoul, South Korea	5	9	23	37	5
11	1990	Beijing, China	1	8	14	23	11
12	1994	Hiroshima, Japan	4	3	15	22	7
13	1998	Bangkok, Thailand	7	11	17	35	9
14	2002	Busan, South Korea	10	12	13	35	8
15	2006	Doha, Qatar	10	17	26	53	8
16	2010	Guangzhou, China	14	17	34	65	6
17	2014	Incheon, South Korea	11	9	37	57	8
18	2018	Jakarta-Palembang, Indonesia	15	24	30	69	8
19	2022*	Hangzhou, China	28	38	41	107	4

*Hangzhou 2022 Asian Games were held in 2023
 Source: Olympic Council of Asia

2023, athletics contributed 29 medals (6 gold, 14 silver, 9 bronze) while shooting's share was 22 (7 gold, 9 silver, 6 bronze). India had won a record 107 medals, including 28 gold, in the 2022 Asian Games.

Toor has been training at the University of Tsukuba near Tokyo as the

74-member Indian athletics team left the country early for a short acclimatization camp.

The team will reach Nagoya on Monday, but Toor will be here on Saturday for the opening ceremony.

"I am feeling proud that I will be one of the flag-bearers of the Indian contingent. It's a

dream of every athlete to be flag-bearer of his or her country. I thank the IOA for giving me the honour," Toor said in a video message from IOA.

"It's a big moment of a lifetime for me that I am going to be the flag-bearer along with an Olympic medalist (Manu Bhaker)."

BCCI office-bearers to look for alternative

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
 Mumbai, September 18

In a major development, the BCCI is set to initiate a search for a new chief selector after Ajit Agarkar informed the board's top brass of his decision not to continue in the high-profile post.

As per sources close to Agarkar, he has already intimated the BCCI that he doesn't intend to continue in the post.

Earlier on Friday, the member units of the BCCI authorized the office-bearers to take a call on chairman of selectors Agarkar's future in the role during the Annual General Meeting here.

Charani, Shafali shine as India outclass Japan to enter semis

Japan's batters could not find a way to force the pace

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
 Nisshin, September 18

Opener Shafali Verma's all-round brilliance and left-arm spinner Shree Charani's devastating spell powered defending gold-medallists India into the Asian Games women's cricket semifinals with a dominant eight-wicket win over an inexperienced Japan, here on Friday.

Charani (4/10) and Shafali (2/13) shared six wickets among them as India bowled out Japan for a paltry 57, and then chased down the target in just five overs to set up a clash with Bangladesh on September 20.

Shafali (40 not out, 15 balls) played the lead role in that pygmy-sized chase, along with Richa Ghosh (12, six balls).

However, Japan also



had some moments to cheer as they managed to dismiss opener Gunalan Kamalini and one down batter Bharti Fulmali.

The ensuing celebrations proved Japan's spirit despite defending an abysmally low target.

But spirit alone could not help them thwart players in the class of Shafali and Ghosh, who took India

home without much fuss.

The credit for restricting Japan to just-above 50 went largely to Indian spinners led by Charani.

Bowling by choice, Indians never gave the Japan batters any chance to free their arms, which was reflected in just three boundaries in the host team's innings.

Davis Cup: India trail Korea 0-2 as Nagal, Suresh squander early leads

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
 Seoul, September 18

India's hopes of making the Davis Cup Final 8 were pushed to the brink after Dhakshineswar Suresh and Sumit Nagal squandered promising starts to lose their respective singles, leaving the visitors trailing 0-2 against Korea at the end of the opening day of their Qualifier tie here on Friday.

Dhakshineswar lost the first match of his fledgling Davis Cup career when Korea's number one player Soonwoo Kwon beat him 3-6 6-3 6-4. The onus to bring India back was on India number one Nagal but he also squandered a solid start to lose 6-2 4-6 5-7 to experienced Hyon Chung after battling for more than three hours.



Champion Khalin Joshi (second from right) receives trophy from Deputy Chief Minister of Chhattisgarh Arun Sao (second from left) Shyam Sunder Bajaj, Vice President and Head of State, Corporate Affairs & Corporate Communications, Chhattisgarh (extreme left) and Vikas Singh, Chief Business Officer, DP World PGTI (extreme right), were also present at the occasion

Chess Olympiad: Indian men beat Italy
 Women's team crushes Greece

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
 Samarkand, September 18

The Indian men's side delivered a 3-1 victory over an all-Grandmaster team from Italy, with Nihal Sarin coming good yet again and reigning world champion D Gukesh returning to winning ways at the 46th Chess Olympiad here on Friday.

Meanwhile, the women's squad crashed through the defences of Greece with a 3.5-0.5 victory to remain in pole position after the third

round. At the top of the tables, R Praggnanandhaa was not able to squeeze out a victory for the second day running against Lorenzo Lodici, but the team-mates Nihal Sarin and Gukesh ensured that an emphatic victory against the Italy was pretty much on cards.

While Nihal accounted for Francesco Sonis, Sabino Brunello was on the receiving end against Gukesh on the fourth board as the Indian think tank decided to field its top team for the first time in the tournament.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
 CORRIGENDUM

Ref: Tender Notice No. 21/2026-2027 dated 19.06.2026 S. No. 03 Tender No. 77269045RGC Opening date 21.07.2026.

In reference to above, tender opening date already extended from 21.07.2026 to 21.08.2026 and 21.08.2026 to 21.09.2026, now this is Third corrigendum, tender opening date has been extended from 21.09.2026 to 21.10.2026. All other terms and conditions remain unchanged.

The corrigendum has been published on website www.ireps.gov.in.

Note: This is the Third Corrigendum in above referred tender.

Date: 17.09.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3246/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. PC/ 84-Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Sh. Akhilesh Kumar Thakur S/o Sh. Lt. Prem Nath Thakur R/o- H. No. KH No. 5299, Street No. 115, Block B Sant Nagar, Village Burari Delhi-84** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.8575/2023 U/s 138 NI Act at P.S. Burari, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sh. Akhilesh Kumar Thakur** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sh. Akhilesh Kumar Thakur** have absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sh. Akhilesh Kumar Thakur** of **FIR No. 8575/2023 U/s 138 NI Act at P.S.: Burari, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 03.11.2026.

By order
 Danveer
 Judicial Magistrate First Class-04
 Room No. 1, Annexe-1, Central District,
 Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi
 DP/13260/N/2026

JHARKHAND BIJLI VITRAN NIGAM LIMITED
 (CIN: U40108JH2013SGC001702)
 Regd. Office:- Engineering Building, HEC, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004.
 fax # 0651-2400483 e-mail : gm.dn@jbvnl.co.in

2nd Extension of Bid submission Date

In continuation to the E-tender floated vide NIT No. 212/PR/JBVNL/26-27 dt. 19.08.2026 for empanelment of agencies for repair of defective Power Transformer (PTRs) of various capacity (e.g. 5MVA, 10 MVA etc.) on rate contract under JBVNL.

It is pertinent to mention that the current last date of submission bid is 15.09.2026 (upto 6:00PM) hence, to ensure fare completion and adequate response the last date of bid submission and opening dates are proposed to be extended due to un-avoidable circumstances. The same available on the Jharkhand Government e-procurement portal (<https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>) on the tender schedule is hereby revised as under.

Sl. No	NIT No.	Description	Estimated value (incl. GST Rs.) (In Crs.)	EMD value (Incl. GST) (Rs. In lacs).	Tender Cost (Incl. GST) (In Rs.)	Downloading / Sale of Tender Document	Pre-Bid Meeting	Last date of sale of tender document	Last Date of submission of bid	Date of Opening of Tender
1	212/PR/JBVNL/2026-27	Empanelment of agencies for repair of defective Power Transformer (PTRs) of various capacity (e.g. 5MVA, 10 MVA etc.) on rate contract under JBVNL.	8.13	16.26	11,800	19.08.26	01.09.26 at 3.00 PM	23.09.26 Up to 05:00PM	23.09.26 Up to 06:00PM	25.09.26 05:00PM

Further details against the above Tender can be obtained from website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> and may be contacted on Mobile No. 9006819264/ 8709711244 & NIC helpline No. 0651-2400178. Email ID:- gm.dn@jbvnl.co.in . Submission of bid document fee and EMD will be accepted through online mode only and receipt/acknowledgement of tender submission of the same should be submitted to the office of undersigned on or before 24.09.2026.

PR No. 387421

स्वचित एवं राष्ट्रहित में ऊर्जा बचाये। कृपया अपनी शिकायतों को टोल फ्री नं० 1800 345 6570 पर दर्ज करायें।

PR 389952 Jharkhand Bijlee Vitran Nigam Ltd(26-27).D

Sd/-
 General Manager (DN)
 JBVNL

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
 OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD R and B DIVISION BAKSHI NAGAR JAMMU
 Short e-NIT No.65 of 2026-2027 Dated:-17-09-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works :-

S. No	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised Cost (Rs. Lakh)	Cost of document (in Rs.)	Earnest Money (In Rs.)	Time Allowed for completion	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	MODERNIZATION AND AESTHETIC UPGRADEATION OF JKAACL KITAB GHAR JAMMU	PWD (R&B) DIVISION BAKSHI NAGAR Jammu	2.55	600/-	2% of Advertised Cost	30 Days	25-09-2026 (12.00 Pm)	"A,B,C&D"
2	Construction of store and service room at 3rd Floor of Circuit House Canal Road Jammu	PWD (R&B) DIVISION BAKSHI NAGAR Jammu	26.00	600/-	2% of Advertised Cost	60 Days	25-09-2026 (12.00 Pm)	"A,B,"

Position of AAA/ TS : Accorded

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen / downloaded from the departmental website <http://jktenders.gov.in> as per below schedule :-

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	17-09-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 17-09-2026 to 24-09-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	
4	Bid submission Start Date	17-09-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	24-09-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	25-09-2026 on or after 1200 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

No:- EE/R&B/BN/6445-6455
 Dated :- 17-09-2026
 DIP No:DIP/J-10799/26

Sd/- (ER. SANDEEP GUPTA)
 Executive Engineer
 PWD (R&B) Division Bakshi Nagar

NORTHERN RAILWAY
 (E-Auction Notice)

Sr.Divisional Commercial Manager/PS, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites bids through e-Auction through IREPS (<https://ireps.gov.in>) for the allotment of Automated Teller Machine/Digital Banking Unit/Banking e-Lobby Contracts at following Railway stations/locations:

E-Catalogue No	Date & Time of bidding	Railway Stations/Locations/Sites
DLI-ATM-05-2026	05.10.2026 at 12.00 Hrs.	Anand Vihar Terminal (2), Tohana (1), Jakhel, (1), Noli (1).

Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen <https://ireps.gov.in/>

All bidders who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfil following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids:

- Registration on IREPS for E-Auction Leasing module -Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module. • Payment of One Time Registration Fee;
- Current Account in State Bank of India. • Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account; • Lien Marking of Funds; • Updation of Turnover Details. • A new mechanism namely Virtual Account Number (VAN) has been introduced now for E-Auction Leasing module, which can be used by the bidders as an alternative to Lien Marking Mechanism. The bidders are free to switch between Lien Marking Mechanism (if activated) and VAN mechanism at any point of time, before entering the bidding room. VAN mechanism does not require the bidder to have a current account in State Bank of India. The users are free to transfer money from any of their existing bank accounts in any bank to their VAN account, which enables them to participate in IREPS E-Auctions.
- Contractors Who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors / Contractors (E-Tender/E-Auction Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.

Railway Authority to contact, in case of any query: Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Commercial Branch, State Entry Road, New Delhi 110055. Email: publicitycell@rail.gov.in Tel: 011-23743084

No:3PUB/ATM/DLI-DIV/E-auction/2022 Dated: 09.09.2026 3251/26

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

UJVN Limited
 (An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
 H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
 (Telephones: 0135-2763508, 2763808 & Fax- 0135- 2763507)
 CIN No.: U40101UR2001SGC025866, website: www.uttarakhandjvalvidyut.com

पत्र सं०: 826 दिनांक: 18 / 09 / 2026

e-Tender Notice

The office of the Executive Engineer (M), UJVN Ltd. Chilla invites sealed tenders from interested firms following details.

Tender No. 13/EE/M/2026-27

1. Name of work: Construction of New Borewell Near Overhead Tank at Chilla Project Colony
2. Estimated Cost : Rs. 74,70,800.00 (GST extra)
3. Date of availability of tender document: 17-09-2026 at 16:00 Hrs
4. Last Date of Receipt of tender: 08-10-2026 at 11:00 Hrs

For fuller and further details kindly visit our website e-procurement Portal uktenders.gov.in.

Executive Engineer(M) , Chilla Power House

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

DELHI TRANSCO LIMITED

NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER

Delhi Transco Ltd., a Government of NCT of Delhi Undertaking, invites online tender for the following work:

Tender No. T26P750011: Strengthening of existing bituminous road of New Kilekari Colony, DTL and Repair of boundary walls along with Internal and External Finishing Works at DTL Rewariline, Najafgarh Colony and Kirtinagar office.

For complete details of the tender please visit following websites :- <https://govtprocurement.delhi.gov.in> (Tender ID No. 2026 DTL 298161.1) and www.dtl.gov.in with Unique No. DTL-0165-090926

Last date for bid submission:- 14.10.2026, 13:00 Hrs.

All Corrigendum/Addendum/ Amendments/Date of Extension/Clarifications etc. to this e-tender will be hosted on the above website only. Bidders should regularly visit website to keep themselves updated.



'NO IS NEVER TAKEN AS NO'

Radhika Apte said Shah Rukh Khan's old films romanticised stalking

Radhika Apte pointed out a troubling pattern in the Bollywood romances she grew up watching, as well as those that came before them. She recently confessed that though she's a 'huge' fan of Shah Rukh Khan, revisiting his old films made her realise how they glorified stalking, which in turn formed the idea of desire among impressionable young women of that time, including her.

In a recent interview with 'News18', Radhika said, "Being tied and our 'pallu' being taken off were the dreams we used to get as teenagers. How scary is that. No offence... I'm a huge Shah Rukh fan, but when I revisited some of the old films I used to like, I was really taken aback. Because when a woman says no, it's never taken as no. Chasing a woman was romance. That's what we wanted at that time and it was really shocking."

Apte admitted that Bollywood has come a long way since then. "We've come a long way, but there's also a long way to go, not only for women, but also men and society. That's all ever-evolving," she added.

Radhika stars in Vikramaditya Motwane's segment in 'Lust Stories 3', an anthology which will release

on 'Netflix' on September 18.

Shakun Batra, who has also helmed a segment in 'Lust Stories 3', argued that over 20 years before Shah Rukh Khan even made his film debut with Raj Kanwar's 1992 action romance 'Deewana', late legendary filmmaker Raj

Kapoor was 'very comfortable with the idea of trying to explore' desire with films like 'Mera Naam Joker' (1970) and 'Ram Teri Ganga Maili' (1985).

Shakun specifically referred to the storyline in 'Mera Naam Joker', in which a young Rishi Kapoor is attracted to his schoolteacher (Simi Garewal) and to the one in 'Ram Teri Ganga Maili', in which a widower (Rajiv Kapoor) finds himself attracted to Mandakini's character.

"But even at that time, the gaze was always male. And the women were sexualised. You're putting that element down and making jokes at its expense anyway. That's the problem - the sexualisation of women and then, by saying, 'Don't sexualise them' and then calling them 'devi' and putting them on some pedestal of morality that you approve of. I find that problematic," countered Apte.

'WE'VE COME A LONG WAY, BUT THERE'S ALSO A LONG WAY TO GO, NOT ONLY FOR WOMEN, BUT ALSO MEN AND SOCIETY,' SHE SAYS

HOLIDAY INN PRESENTS 'THE GREAT THAI FEAST' FOOD FESTIVAL

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Holiday Inn New Delhi Mayur Vihar Noida invites guests to embark on a vibrant culinary journey through Thailand with 'The Great Thai Feast' food festival hosted at its Pan-Asian speciality restaurant, The Noble House till September 20, 2026, for lunch and dinner.

Celebrating the bold, aromatic and beautifully balanced flavours of Thai cuisine, the festival brings together a curated à la carte selection featuring classic favourites thoughtfully crafted by the hotel's culinary team.

The menu opens with comforting Thai flavours such as Tangy Pumpkin Soup, Tom Kha and Lemongrass Clear Soup. Guests can savour signature starters including Thai Herb Fried Chicken, Chicken Satay with Spicy Peanut Sauce, Pad Kra Pao Goong and Crispy Fried Tofu with Honey Plum Sauce.

The main course showcases the depth and diversity of Thai cuisine with highlights such as Chicken Kra Pao, Stir-Fried Lobster with Pineapple Chilli Sauce, Chilean Seabass with Cilantro Sour Chilli Sauce, Stir-Fried Pork with Spicy Green Beans and the much-loved Kao Pad Goong. Vegetarian selections include Hormok Phak, exotic vegetables in tamarind sauce and Pad Mhee Korat.

To complete the experience, guests can indulge in Thai-inspired desserts including Crispy Fried Banana in Chocolate Dip and Coconut Cake with Mango Sauce.

Adding to the culinary experience, The Noble House has been transformed with Thai-inspired décor and visual elements, creating an immersive setting inspired by the colours, culture and warmth of Thailand. Guests will also enjoy Thai music complementing the dining experience and bringing an added sense of place to the five-day celebration.

Commenting on the festival, Shashi Shankar, F&B Manager, Holiday Inn New Delhi Mayur Vihar Noida, said, "The Great Thai Feast" is our invitation to guests to discover the vibrant flavours and spirit of Thailand through



Venue: Holiday Inn New Delhi Mayur Vihar Noida

13A, District Centre, Mayur Vihar, New Delhi - 110091

For reservations and more information, call +91 8860605520

THE FESTIVAL CELEBRATES THE BOLD, AROMATIC AND BEAUTIFULLY BALANCED FLAVOURS OF THAI CUISINE

an experience that brings together food, music and ambience. With a thoughtfully curated à la carte menu, we look forward to creating memorable dining moments for our guests at The Noble House."

Ashutosh Bisht, Executive Chef, Holiday Inn New Delhi Mayur Vihar Noida, added, "Thai cuisine is all about balance: sweet, sour, salty, spicy and aromatic flavours coming together beautifully. For 'The Great Thai Feast', our team has curated a selection that celebrates these distinctive characteristics while offering guests a diverse choice of soups, starters, mains and desserts."

'DUPAHIYA' S2

Dhadakpur is back with more chaos & newer problems!

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Prime Video' announced October 1, 2026, as the worldwide premiere date of season two of its 'Hindi Original' series, 'Dupahiya'.

Set in the quirky and no longer crime-free fictional village of Dhadakpur, the comedy-drama series is back with its unique blend of innocence, madness and small-town charm, with a fresh set of challenges that promise bigger chaos and plenty of laughs.

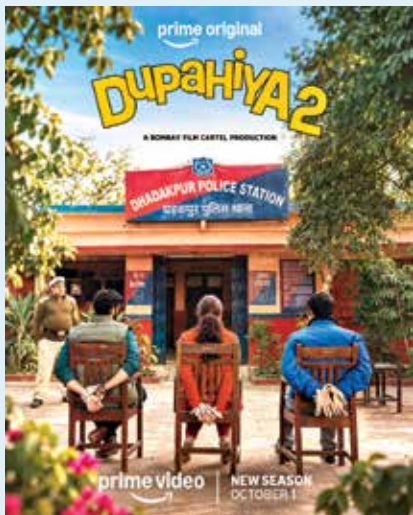
After a successful season one, the new season returns

IT FEATURES GAJRAJ RAO, RENUKA SHAHANE, SPARSH SHRIVASTAVA, BHUVAN ARORA, SHIVANI RAGHUVANSHI AND YASHPAL SHARMA, WITH DINESH LAL YADAV (NIRAHUA) JOINING THE CAST

with its ensemble star cast, featuring Gajraj Rao, Renuka Shahane, Sparsh Shrivastava, Bhuvan Arora, Shivani Raghuvanshi and Yashpal Sharma,

with Dinesh Lal Yadav (Nirahua) joining the team.

"The greatest testament of success for us is when a story instantly connects with audiences. When the characters start becoming part of dinner-table conversations, we know we've done something right. 'Dupahiya' is a perfect example of this. The first season received so much love from audiences and performed incredibly well on the service," said Nikhil Madhok, Director and Head of Originals (SVOD), 'Prime Video' and 'Amazon MGM Studios India'.



'Would love to meet you all'

'The Scandal' lead stars Son Ye-jin, Ji Chang-wook and Nana's sent messages to Indian fans



The 'Scandal' star Son Ye-jin said she would love to visit India and get a good Ayurveda massage, while her co-stars, Ji Chang-wook and Nana, hope fans in the country enjoy their new drama, a twisted tale of love and desire set in the past.

Ye-jin's romantic shows 'Something in the Rain' and 'Crash Landing on You' have made her popular beyond Korea, where she has been a reigning queen of K-dramas and movies since 2003. "It's exhilarating for me to know that there are Indians out there who love our shows. I'd really love to visit India because I heard that the Ayurveda oil massage is really famous there and I'd love to get some. I heard it's very therapeutic and it's very healing for the soul. So, I definitely want to go there for those massages," Ye-

jin, who plays Lady Cho in 'The Scandal', told PTI in an interview.

The 'Netflix' series, which premiered Friday, is inspired by popular 2003 Korean film 'Untold Scandal', which, in turn, was loosely based on the 1782 French novel 'Les Liaisons dangereuses'. Set during the Joseon dynasty (1392-1897), 'The Scandal' follows the daring and dangerous game of love between Ye-jin's Lady Cho, a woman too extraordinary to be confined to women's quarters and her cousin Cho-won (Ji Chang-wook), the greatest playboy in Joseon. Nana essays the role of Hui-yeon, a widow who unknowingly becomes entangled in their wager.

Chang-wook, whose credits include popular dramas such as 'Impress Ki', 'Healer', 'Susi-

cious Partner', 'The Worst of Evil' and 'Welcome to Samdal-ri', is hopeful that fans in India will love his latest work. "Fans in India, it's nice to see you. I'm a little shy and awkward, but I'll try my best: it's lovely to meet you. It's so cool that I get to have this interview with a reporter from India and leave a video message to fans in India. I hope our fans enjoy 'The Scandal'. If I have a chance to visit India, I'd love to meet you all. Thank you," he said.

Nana, an actress-singer who has worked in dramas such as 'Into The Ring' and 'The Mask Girl', said she loves her fans in India and hoped that they overcome obstacles in their lives the way her character, Hui-yeon, does in 'The Scandal'. "To

the Indian fans out there, I know it'll be best if everything happy happens to you. But sometimes there are obstacles in life. Just like in the series 'The Scandal', there could be some hurts; there could be some wounds." AGENCIES



CBFC'S NEW FILM CERTIFICATION GUIDELINES

No glorification of violence, anti-national attitudes

Sexual violence should be minimised as well

OUR CORRESPONDENT

After the Centre reconstituted the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC) with a new 18-member committee that includes film personalities, writers, musicians and several figures linked to the BJP, the film body has now rolled out a revised framework for film certification in India, replacing the 1991 guidelines.

In the new framework, the CBFC has made it clear that violence can't be glorified and films must be restricted from showing the modus operandi of criminals or content that could incite real-world offences.

The Board has asked that pointless or avoidable scenes of violence, cruelty and horror, scenes of violence primarily intended to provide entertainment and such scenes as may have the effect of desensitising or dehumanising people are not to be shown. Also, the Board has asked not to show scenes which have the effect of justifying or glorifying drinking, glamourise drug addiction and consumption of tobacco or smoking. Depictions involving narcotic drugs/psychotropic substances must carry the prescribed anti-drug warning.

The Board also has a message for filmmakers not to show content showing children as victims, perpetrators or forced witnesses of violence or being subjected to child abuse. The film certification body also asked filmmakers to refrain from showing needless depictions of cruelty to animals and abuse or ridicule of physically or mentally disabled persons is prohibited.

As in the case of sexual con-



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

ALSO, THE BOARD HAS ASKED NOT TO SHOW SCENES WHICH HAVE THE EFFECT OF JUSTIFYING OR GLORIFYING DRINKING

tent and treatment of women, content degrading or denigrating women shouldn't be shown. Sexual violence should be minimised, where essential to the story, shown without graphic detail. Sexual content described in the guidelines as 'sexual perversions' is similarly to be avoided or minimised where germane to the theme.

The Board also asked directors to refrain from content which shows contemptuous visuals or words targeting racial, religious or other groups or promote communal, obscurantist, anti-scientific or 'antinational' attitudes. Films that question India's sovereignty and integrity, endanger state security or public order or strain friendly relations with foreign countries are also barred.

The revised guidelines retain the previous age-based UA system.